COMSATS University Islamabad, Sahiwal Campus

Crisis Alert System With GPS Precision

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COMSATS University Islamabad, Sahiwal Campus

Crisis Alert System with GPS Precision

A project presented to

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In partial fulfillment

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CERTIFICATE OF APPROVAL

It is to certify that the final year project of BS (SE) **"Crisis Alert System with GPS Precision"** was developed by **Danish Ali Sheroz (CIIT/FA22-BSE-008/SWL)**, **Muhammad Affan (CIIT/FA22-BSE-024/SWL)**, **Muhammad Usman Rafiq (CIIT/FA22-BSE-057/SWL)**under the supervision of **"Ms. Fatima Khan"** and that in their opinion, it is fully adequate, in scope and quality for the degree of Bachelor of Science in Computer Sciences.

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Executive Summary

Crisis Alert System with GPS Precision is a comprehensive web-based emergency management platform developed to improve crisis reporting and response in real time.

It focuses on efficient communication, accurate location tracking, and better coordination among different agencies. Through detailed research, several gaps were identified in traditional emergency systems, including delayed alert delivery, poor communication, and lack of automation, which often increase response time and risk to life and property. To address these issues, the system provides an intelligent and integrated solution by combining Natural Language Processing (NLP), real-time GPS services, and automated notification mechanisms. Users can easily submit emergency alerts through a simple and user-friendly interface, after which the system automatically detects the type and severity of the emergency and extracts the location either from the message text or GPS coordinates. Relevant responders are instantly notified through email alerts and system notifications to ensure quick action.

The platform includes multiple core modules such as user authentication, emergency alert submission, NLP-based classification, location mapping, data storage, notification delivery, and monitoring dashboard. Administrators and responders can track incidents in real time, update statuses, and generate analytical reports for better decision-making. The system was developed using the Incremental Model of the Software Development Life Cycle, starting with basic features and gradually adding advanced functionalities.

One unique feature of this system is SIM-based voice calling for critical situations, which ensures communication even when internet connectivity is not available. Overall, this project demonstrates strong technical capabilities in web development, NLP, and database management while providing a reliable and modern solution for effective crisis management.

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Abbreviations

Abbreviation	Meaning
CAS	Crisis Alert System
NLP	Natural Language Processing
GPS	Global Positioning System
HTML	Hypertext Markup Language
CSS	Cascading Style Sheets
JS	JavaScript
PHP	Hypertext Preprocessor
API	Application Programming Interface
DBMS	Database Management System
SQL	Structured Query Language
MVC	Model-View-Controller
REST	Representational State Transfer
UI	User Interface
UX	User Experience
MySQL	My Structured Query Language
SMTP	Simple Mail Transfer Protocol
HTTPS	Hypertext Transfer Protocol Secure
RBAC	Role-Based Access Control
OOP	Object-Oriented Programming
OOD	Object-Oriented Design
SDLC	Software Development Life Cycle
SRS	Software Requirements Specification

SDD	Software Design Description
RTM	Requirements Traceability Matrix
UML	Unified Modeling Language
DFD	Data Flow Diagram
ERD	Entity Relationship Diagram
IDE	Integrated Development Environment
UT	Unit Testing
FT	Functional Testing
IT	Integration Testing
UAT	User Acceptance Testing
FEMA	Federal Emergency Management Agency
IPAWS	Integrated Public Alert and Warning System

Table of Contents

Chapter 1 1
INTRODUCTION 1
1.1 Introduction 2
1.2 Brief 2
1.2.1 User Authentication and Role-Based Access Control 3
1.2.2 Emergency Alert Submission 3
1.2.3 Automatic Message Classification (NLP) 3
1.2.4 Location Extraction and Mapping 4
1.2.5 Incident Record Creation and Storage 4
1.2.6 Notification Delivery System 4
1.2.8 Incident Status Update and Remarks 5
1.2.9 Reporting and Analytics 5
1.2.10 Activity Logging and Audit Trail 6
1.3 Relevance to Course Modules 6
1.3.2 Software Engineering 6
1.3.3 Database Management Systems 7
1.3.4 Artificial Intelligence (NLP) 7
1.3.5 Human-Computer Interaction (HCI) 7
1.4 Project Background 7
1.5 Literature Review 8
1.6 Analysis from Literature Review 9
1.6.1 User Authentication and Access Control 9
1.6.2 NLP-Based Emergency Classification 9
1.6.3 Location Tracking and Mapping 10
1.6.4 Notification and Alert Systems 10
1.6.5 Real-Time Dashboard and Monitoring 10
1.7 Methodology and Software Lifecycle 10
1.7.1 Modular Development Approach 10
1.7.2 Object-Oriented Development (OOD) 10
1.7.3 Incremental Approach 10
1.7.4 Rationale Behind the Selected Methodology 11
1.7.5 Software Development Life Cycle (SDLC) 11
1.7.5.1 Planning and Requirements Gathering 11
1.7.5.2 Design 11
1.7.5.3 Implementation 12
1.7.5.4 Testing 12

1.7.5.5 Deployment and Maintenance 12
Chapter 2 13
PROBLEM DEFINITION 13
2.1 Problem Statement 14
2.2 Deliverables Requirements 14
2.2.1 Crisis Alert System Platform 14
2.2.2 Documentation 15
2.2.3 Testing Reports 15
2.2.4 Deployment Setup 16
2.3 Development Requirements 16
2.3.1 Technologies and Tools - Frontend 16
2.3.2 Technologies and Tools - Backend 16
2.3.3 Server and Hosting Requirements 16
2.3.4 Performance and Scalability 17
2.3.5 Security and Privacy 17
2.3.7 Collaboration and Version Control 18
2.4 Current System 18
Chapter 3 20
REQUIREMENT ANALYSIS 20
3.1 Use Case Diagram 21
3.2 Functional Requirements 22
3.3 Non-Functional Requirements 24
3.3.1 Usability 24
3.3.2 Performance 24
3.3.3 Security 24
3.3.4 Portability 24
3.3.5 Reliability 24
3.3.6 Maintainability 25
3.3.7 Scalability 25
3.3.8 Compatibility 25
Chapter 4 26
DESIGN AND ARCHITECTURE 26
4.1 System Architecture 27
4.2 Data Representation 28
4.3 Process Flow/Representation 29
4.3.1 Activity Diagrams 30
4.4 Process Flow Diagram 33
4.5 Design Models 34
4.5.1 Class Diagram 34

4.5.2 Sequence Diagram 35
4.5.3 Data Flow Diagram (DFD) 37
4.6 Data Design 39
4.6.1 Data Dictionary 39
Chapter 5 41
IMPLEMENTATION 41
5.1 Algorithms 42
5.1.1 User Authentication Algorithm 42
5.1.2 Emergency Message Processing Algorithm 43
5.1.3 NLP-Based Crisis Classification Algorithm 44
5.1.4 Location Extraction and Mapping Algorithm 45
5.1.5 Database CRUD Operations 46
5.1.6 Alert Notification Algorithm 47
5.1.7 Dashboard Population Algorithm 48
5.2 External APIs and Integrations 49
5.3 User Interface Design 50
5.3.1 Home Screen / Landing Page 50
5.3.3 Emergency Alert Submission Form 52
5.3.4 Location Permission and Map Display 53
5.3.5 Submission Confirmation Screen 55
5.3.6 Responder Dashboard 55
5.3.7 Incident Detail View 56
5.3.8 Incident Status Update Interface 57
5.3.9 Admin Panel - User Management 58
5.3.10 Admin Panel - System Configuration 58
5.3.11 Reporting and Analytics Dashboard 59
5.3.12 Email Notification Interface 60
Chapter 6 61
TESTING AND EVALUATION 61
6.1 Testing Overview 62
6.2 Unit Testing Results 62
6.2.1 Unit Test 1: User Registration 62
6.2.2 Unit Test 2: User Login 63
6.2.3 Unit Test 3: Admin Login 63
6.2.4 Unit Test 4: Emergency Alert Submission 64
6.2.5 Unit Test 5: Location Detection 64
6.2.6 Unit Test 6: NLP Message Classification 65
6.2.7 Unit Test 7: Email Notification Dispatch 65
6.2.8 Unit Test 8: Incident Status Update 66

6.3 Functional Testing 66
6.4 Integration Testing 67
6.5 Performance Testing 68
6.6 Security Testing 68
6.7 User Acceptance Testing (UAT) 68
6.8 Test Summary and Evaluation 69
Chapter 7 70
CONCLUSION AND FUTURE WORK 70
7.1 Project Summary 71
7.2 Achievements 72
7.3 Challenges and Lessons Learned 72
7.4 Future Work 73
7.4.1 Enhanced NLP with Multi-Language Support 73
7.4.2 Mobile Application Development 73
7.4.3 SMS and Voice Call Integration 73
7.4.4 AI-Based Resource Allocation 73
7.4.5 Multi-Agency Coordination Features 74
7.4.6 Offline Mode and Progressive Web App (PWA) 74
7.4.7 Social Media Integration 74
7.4.8 Predictive Analytics for Crisis Prevention 74
7.4.9 IoT Device Integration 74
7.4.10 Blockchain for Incident Verification 75
Chapter 8 76
REFERENCES 76

List of Figures

Figure 3.1-1: Use Case Diagram 22
Figure 4.1-1: System Architecture Diagram 28
Figure 4.2-1: Entity Relationship Diagram 29
Figure 4.3-1: Citizen Activity Diagram 30
Figure 4.3-2: Responder Activity Diagram 31
Figure 4.3-3: Admin Activity Diagram 32
Figure 4.4-1: Process Flow Diagram 33
Figure 4.5-1: Class Diagram 35
Figure 4.5-2: Sequence Diagram 36
Figure 4.5.3: Data Flow Diagram 38
Figure 5.3-1: Home Screen 50
Figure 5.3-2: Registration Screen 51
Figure 5.3-3: Login Screen 52
Figure 5.3-4: Emergency Alert Submission Form 53
Figure 5.3-5: Location Permission Dialog 54
Figure 5.3-6: Map Display with User Location 54
Figure 5.3-7: Submission Confirmation Screen 55
Figure 5.3-8: Responder Dashboard 56
Figure 5.3-9: Incident Detail View 57
Figure 5.3-10: Incident Status Update Interface 57
Figure 5.3-11: Admin Panel - User Management 58
Figure 5.3-12: Admin Panel - System Configuration 59
Figure 5.3-13: Reporting and Analytics Dashboard 60
Figure 5.3-14: Email Notification Received 60

List of Table

Table 1-1: Literature Review Summary 8
Table 2.3.6: Development Milestones 18
Table 3.2.1: User Module (Citizen) 22
Table 3.2.2: Responder Module 23
Table 3.2.3: Admin Module 23
Table 4-1: users Table Schema 39
Table 4-2: incidents Table Schema 39
Table 4-3: Notifications Table Schema 40
Table 4-4: logs Table Schema 40
Table 5-1: External APIs and Integrations 49
Table 6-1: Unit Test - User Registration 62
Table 6-2: Unit Test - User Login 63
Table 6-3: Unit Test - Admin Login 63
Table 6-4: Unit Test - Emergency Alert Submission 64
Table 6-5: Unit Test - Location Detection 64
Table 6-6: Unit Test - NLP Message Classification 65
Table 6-7: Unit Test - Email Notification Dispatch 65
Table 6-8: Unit Test - Incident Status Update 66
Table 6-9: Functional Test - Complete Emergency Reporting Flow 66
Table 6-12: Integration Test - Frontend-Backend Communication 67
Table 6-13: Integration Test - Database Integration 67
Table 6-14: Integration Test - API Integration 67
Table 6-15: Performance Test Results 68
Table 6-16: Security Test Results 68
Table 6.7.1: Summary of UAT Feedback: 69
Table 6.8,1: Test Summary and Evaluation 69
Table 7.2.1: Achievements 72
Table 7.3.1: Challenges Encountered: 72

Chapter 1

INTRODUCTION

1.1 Introduction

The **Crisis Alert System with GPS Precision** is a comprehensive web-based emergency management platform developed to address critical challenges in crisis communication, incident classification, and real-time response coordination. As natural disasters, accidents, medical emergencies, and security threats continue to pose significant risks to communities worldwide, the need for efficient, reliable, and intelligent emergency response systems has never been more pressing. Traditional emergency reporting mechanisms often suffer from delayed communication, inaccurate location information, fragmented data sharing among responders, and lack of automated incident prioritization.

Through extensive research and observation of existing emergency response systems, we identified that many crisis situations escalate due to slow alert dissemination, confusion about incident nature and severity, and inefficient coordination between multiple response agencies. Citizens reporting emergencies often struggle to provide precise location details under stress, while responders waste valuable time gathering basic information that could have been automated. The Crisis Alert System bridges these critical gaps by offering an intelligent, integrated solution that combines Natural Language Processing (NLP), real-time geolocation services, automated notification delivery, and a centralized coordination dashboard.

This platform is built to serve a diverse range of stakeholders, from citizens seeking to report emergencies quickly and accurately, to first responders requiring real-time situational awareness, to emergency managers needing comprehensive incident oversight and resource coordination capabilities. It promotes faster response times, improved communication accuracy, and better resource allocation by enabling automated message classification, precise location tracking, and instant multi-channel alerts.

The goal of this project is to enhance emergency response effectiveness and ultimately save lives by merging artificial intelligence capabilities with real-time communication technologies. More than just a technical solution, the Crisis Alert System represents a human-centric approach to solving real-world safety challenges through innovation, thoughtful design, and commitment to social impact. The system is designed to reduce response times, minimize human error in emergency reporting, and provide responders with the accurate, actionable information they need when every second counts.

1.2 Brief

The Crisis Alert System with GPS Precision provides real-time emergency alert processing, NLP-based message classification, GPS location extraction, automated responder notification, and an intuitive incident coordination dashboard. All components are structured to enhance emergency

response efficiency and streamline crisis management workflows. The system is divided into the following core modules:

1.2.1 User Authentication and Role-Based Access Control

This module manages secure access to the platform for all user types. New users can register using their email addresses, while returning users log in securely to access role-specific features. The system implements role-based access control (RBAC) with three distinct roles:

- **Citizen/User**: Can submit emergency alerts, view submission confirmations, and track incident status (future enhancement)
- **Responder**: Can view all active incidents on the dashboard, update incident statuses, add remarks, and receive notifications
- **Administrator**: Has complete system access including user management, system configuration, report generation, and audit log review

  The authentication system uses secure password hashing, session management, and input validation to protect user accounts and prevent unauthorized access. Admins can manage user accounts, assign roles, and monitor system activity through dedicated admin interfaces.

1.2.2 Emergency Alert Submission

This module provides citizens with a simple, intuitive interface for reporting emergencies. Users can type a description of the emergency in plain text, optionally select a crisis category from a dropdown menu (Fire, Accident, Medical, Natural Disaster, Other), and submit the report with a single click. The form includes validation to ensure meaningful messages are submitted and provides clear error messages for incomplete or invalid inputs.

The submission process is designed to be completed in under 30 seconds, recognizing that users may be under stress during actual emergencies. The interface is mobile-responsive, ensuring accessibility from smartphones, tablets, and desktop computers.

1.2.3 Automatic Message Classification (NLP)

At the heart of the Crisis Alert System is the NLP-based automatic message classification engine. When a user submits an emergency message, the system analyzes the text using natural language processing techniques to:

- **Identify Crisis Type**: Classifies the emergency as Fire, Accident, Medical Emergency, Natural Disaster, or Other based on keyword analysis and contextual understanding
- **Determine Severity**: Calculates a severity score based on urgency indicators, threat level keywords, and contextual factors

- **Extract Key Information**: Identifies critical details such as number of people affected, specific location references, and time-sensitive information

  This automated classification reduces manual workload for emergency dispatchers, minimizes human error in categorization, and ensures that incidents are routed to appropriate responders immediately upon submission.

1.2.4 Location Extraction and Mapping

Accurate location information is critical for effective emergency response. This module automatically captures the user's current location using the browser's HTML5 geolocation API. When a user grants location permission, the system retrieves precise latitude and longitude coordinates, performs reverse geocoding to obtain a human-readable address, and plots the incident location on an interactive map. If the user denies location access or if automatic detection fails, the system provides a fallback option for manual address entry. All location data is stored with each incident record, enabling responders to navigate directly to the emergency site using standard mapping applications.

1.2.5 Incident Record Creation and Storage

Every submitted emergency alert generates a structured incident record in the MySQL database. Each incident record includes:

- Unique incident identifier
- User ID of the reporter
- Full message text
- Classified crisis type and severity score
- Latitude, longitude, and address
- Timestamp of submission
- Current status (Pending, In-Progress, Resolved)
- Last update timestamp
- Responder remarks (when applicable)

This structured storage ensures data integrity, enables efficient querying and filtering, and provides a complete audit trail of all emergency reports.

1.2.6 Notification Delivery System

Once an incident is classified and saved, the notification system automatically sends alerts to all registered responders via email. Each notification includes:

- Emergency type and severity
- Incident description

- Location (address and coordinates)
- Timestamp of report
- Link to view full incident details on the dashboard

The email notification system uses SMTP protocol and is designed to be reliable, with automatic retry mechanisms for failed deliveries. Future enhancements will include SMS notifications, in-app push notifications, and voice call capabilities for critical emergencies.

1.2.7 Incident Monitoring Dashboard

The coordination dashboard serves as the central command center for responders and administrators. This real-time interface displays:

- All active incidents on an interactive map with color-coded markers by crisis type
- Incident cards/list view with key details (type, location, status, time)
- Filtering controls by crisis type, status, and date range
- Real-time updates as new incidents are reported
- Incident detail views with complete information

The dashboard enables responders to maintain situational awareness, prioritize incidents based on severity and type, and coordinate response efforts effectively from a single interface.

1.2.8 Incident Status Update and Remarks

Responders and administrators can update incident statuses through the dashboard interface. Available status values include:

- **Pending**: Initial state when incident is first reported
- **In-Progress**: Responder has acknowledged and is addressing the incident
- **Resolved**: Incident has been successfully resolved

Users can also add remarks to incidents, providing additional context, documenting response actions, or sharing updates with other team members. All status changes and remarks are timestamped and logged for audit purposes.

1.2.9 Reporting and Analytics

The admin panel includes comprehensive reporting and analytics capabilities. Administrators can generate reports on:

- Incident volume by type, status, and time period
- Average response and resolution times
- Responder activity and performance metrics
- Geographic distribution of incidents

These reports support data-driven decision making, resource allocation optimization, and continuous improvement of emergency response processes.

1.2.10 Activity Logging and Audit Trail

All significant system actions are logged for security, troubleshooting, and compliance purposes. The audit log records:

- User authentication events (login, logout, failed attempts)
- Incident submissions and updates
- Notification deliveries
- Configuration changes
- User management actions (create, update, delete)

Each log entry includes timestamp, user ID, action description, and related incident ID (where applicable).

1.2.11 System Configuration Management

Administrators can configure system parameters through a dedicated interface, including:

- Responder email lists and grouping
- Notification templates
- Crisis type definitions and classification keywords
- System operational settings

This flexibility allows the system to be adapted to different organizational needs without requiring code changes.

1.3 Relevance to Course Modules

The Crisis Alert System demonstrates practical application of several core computer science modules covered throughout our Bachelor of Computer Science degree program. It reflects how theoretical knowledge can be transformed into a functional, socially impactful web platform.

1.3.1 Web Development

The front end of the Crisis Alert System was built using HTML5, CSS3, JavaScript (ES6+), and Bootstrap framework. These technologies, learned during web development courses, enabled us to design a responsive, intuitive, and cross-platform user interface that supports emergency alert submission, map visualization, and real-time dashboard updates across desktop and mobile devices.

1.3.2 Software Engineering

Principles from software engineering such as modular design, incremental development, requirement analysis, and design documentation were fundamental in structuring the system. These helped us plan,

organize, and manage the development of multiple modules including user authentication, NLP classification, notification systems, and the coordination dashboard. The application of UML diagrams (use case, class, sequence, activity) for system modeling directly reflects software engineering best practices.

1.3.3 Database Management Systems

Using MySQL with PHP PDO for database interactions, we designed the backend to handle user profiles, incident records, location data, notification logs, and audit trails. Normalization techniques, foreign key constraints, and optimized queries came directly from DBMS coursework and ensure data integrity and efficient retrieval.

1.3.4 Artificial Intelligence (NLP)

The NLP-based emergency message classification system is a core innovation of this project. By applying natural language processing principles learned through AI coursework, we implemented text preprocessing, keyword extraction, and rule-based classification algorithms that enable the system to automatically identify crisis types and severity from unstructured text input.

1.3.5 Human-Computer Interaction (HCI)

From interface layout and color schemes to navigation flow and error messaging, the design was shaped by HCI principles to ensure users can operate the system efficiently even under stressful emergency conditions. Features such as simplified forms, clear feedback messages, intuitive.

1.4 Project Background

The concept for the Crisis Alert System arose from observing how emergency response systems in Pakistan and many other countries still rely heavily on manual processes, phone calls, and fragmented communication channels. Citizens reporting emergencies often face long wait times on emergency hotlines, struggle to describe their location accurately under stress, and receive no confirmation that help is on the way. Dispatchers manually log incident details, which can lead to data entry errors, misclassification, and delayed notification of field responders.

During our research, we studied major disasters and everyday emergencies where response times directly impacted outcomes. We found that:

- **Delayed detection** of emergencies leads to escalation of damage and risk
- **Inaccurate location information** causes responders to waste critical minutes searching for incident sites
- **Poor classification** results in wrong types of responders being dispatched
- **Lack of coordination tools** leads to duplicate efforts and resource conflicts

These findings motivated us to develop a system that automates and streamlines the entire emergency handling workflow, from citizen report to responder notification and coordination.

The Crisis Alert System is a web-based platform that enables users to report emergencies with simple text input, automatically captures their precise location, classifies the emergency type using NLP, and instantly notifies relevant responders. The platform includes an interactive dashboard for incident monitoring, status management, and analytics. Users can interact with the system from any device with a web browser and internet connection.

The inclusion of NLP, real-time geolocation, automated notifications, and comprehensive dashboards makes the Crisis Alert System a practical, innovative solution for modern emergency management. It serves as a direct response to the real challenges faced by emergency response organizations and the communities they serve.

1.5 Literature Review

Table 1.1 summarizes the gaps in existing emergency response and crisis management systems, such as FEMA IPAWS, Everbridge, Sahana Eden, CodeRED, and Alertus. The analysis highlights issues such as limited NLP integration for automatic message classification, lack of real-time geospatial visualization for field coordination, fragmented responder communication tools, and insufficient analytics capabilities. The Crisis Alert System addresses these gaps by offering an all-in-one solution with advanced NLP-based classification, real-time incident mapping, automated multi-channel notifications, a centralized coordination dashboard, role-based access control, and comprehensive reporting features to improve emergency response effectiveness.

Table 1-1: Literature Review Summary

Platform	**Weakness**	**Proposed Solution in Crisis Alert System**
FEMA Integrated Public Alert and Warning System (IPAWS)	Mainly focused on mass alerts, lacks detailed real-time coordination tools for responders	Adds a coordination dashboard with real-time incident visualization and team management capabilities
Everbridge	Expensive and complex, may be difficult for smaller agencies to adopt fully	Designed to be cost-effective, user-friendly, and scalable for organizations of all sizes
Sahana Eden	Powerful but can be complicated to set up and use, with limited automation features	Automates alert classification and notification to reduce manual workload and errors; supports multi-user

		collaboration with live map dashboards
CodeRED	Lacks support for multi-channel team coordination or live dashboard features	Web-based platform supports remote and wide-area crisis management; includes live dashboard and team coordination tools
Alerts	Not suitable for field coordination or large-area public emergency monitoring	Designed for both indoor and outdoor emergency management with GPS precision and real-time updates
Traditional Emergency Hotlines	Manual call handling leads to delays, data entry errors, and no location automation	Automated text-based submission with NLP classification and automatic GPS location capture

1.6 Analysis from Literature Review

The analysis highlights critical gaps in existing crisis response systems, including lack of automated classification, imprecise location handling, fragmented responder communication, and limited analytics. The Crisis Alert System solves these issues by offering:

- NLP-based automatic message classification
- Automatic GPS location capture with reverse geocoding
- Centralized real-time incident dashboard
- Automated email notifications to responders
- Role-based access control for security

1.6.1 User Authentication and Access Control

While most emergency systems offer basic login functionality, few provide granular role-based access control tailored to emergency response workflows. The Crisis Alert System enables secure registration and login for citizens, responders, and administrators, with permissions carefully aligned to each role's responsibilities. Responders can view and update incidents but cannot modify system configuration; administrators have full system control.

1.6.2 NLP-Based Emergency Classification

Existing platforms rarely incorporate automated message classification, instead relying on manual categorization by dispatchers. Our solution uses natural language processing to analyze emergency messages in real-time, automatically detecting crisis type and severity. This reduces dispatcher workload, minimizes misclassification errors, and accelerates incident routing to appropriate responders.

1.6.3 Location Tracking and Mapping

Many existing systems rely on users to manually enter addresses, which is error-prone and time-consuming. Our solution automatically captures GPS coordinates using the browser's geolocation API, performs reverse geocoding to obtain addresses, and plots incidents on interactive maps. This ensures responders have accurate location information immediately upon incident creation.

1.6.4 Notification and Alert Systems

Traditional systems often use single notification channels (e.g., only email or only SMS) which may fail or be delayed. Our solution implements email notifications with retry logic, and future enhancements will add SMS, push notifications, and voice call capabilities for redundant.

1.6.5 Real-Time Dashboard and Monitoring

Unlike systems that provide static reports or require manual refresh, our dashboard updates in real-time as incidents are reported and statuses change. The map visualization with color-coded markers enables responders to quickly understand incident distribution and prioritize responses geographically.

1.7 Methodology and Software Lifecycle

The development of the Crisis Alert System followed a modular, object-oriented, and incremental approach to ensure clarity, scalability, and efficiency.

1.7.1 Modular Development Approach

The system is broken into independent modules: user authentication, emergency submission, NLP classification, location extraction, notification delivery, dashboard display, incident management, reporting, and admin configuration. Each module was developed and tested independently for easier debugging and future scalability.

1.7.2 Object-Oriented Development (OOD)

OOD concepts were used to model real-world entities like User, Incident, Location, Notification, and Log. This ensures the code is reusable, maintainable, and aligned with best practices. Inheritance allows Admin and Responder to extend base User functionality, while encapsulation protects sensitive data.

1.7.3 Incremental Approach

Using the Incremental Model, we implemented core features first (user authentication and alert submission), followed by NLP classification, then location mapping, then notification systems, and finally the dashboard and reporting modules. Each increment was tested before moving to the next phase.

1.7.4 Rationale Behind the Selected Methodology

This hybrid approach ensures:

- **Modular Clarity**: Each component (authentication, classification, mapping, notifications) is self-contained, enabling focused development and easier debugging
- **Code Reusability**: OOP principles abstract common functionality into reusable classes, reducing duplication and improving maintainability
- **Continuous Testing**: Each increment is tested independently, allowing early bug identification.

1.7.5 Software Development Life Cycle (SDLC)

For the Crisis Alert System, the Incremental Model was adopted within the SDLC framework. This model divides development into smaller, manageable parts (increments), each delivering functional components. This approach ensured timely delivery of core features and allowed flexibility for refinement based on testing outcomes.

1.7.5.1 Planning and Requirements Gathering

During this initial phase, detailed requirements were collected based on the core objective: delivering an efficient, intelligent emergency reporting and response platform. Key features identified included:

- NLP-based emergency message classification
- Automatic GPS location capture and mapping
- User authentication with role-based access (citizen, responder, admin)
- Automated email notifications to responders
- Real-time incident monitoring dashboard
- Incident status tracking and management
- Reporting and analytics for administrators
- Activity logging and audit trails

1.7.5.2 Design

A detailed object-oriented design was created for each module:

- **Frontend Design**: Responsive user interface using HTML5, CSS3, Bootstrap, and JavaScript
- **Backend Structure**: Modeled using PHP classes for User, Incident, Location, Notification, and Log
- **Database Design**: Normalized MySQL schema with tables for users, incidents, locations, notifications, and logs
- **NLP Module**: Designed for text preprocessing, keyword extraction, and rule-based classification
- **API Integrations**: Google Maps API for geocoding and mapping; SMTP for email notifications

1.7.5.3 Implementation

Implementation followed an incremental rollout:

- **Increment 1**: User authentication and basic alert submission
- **Increment 2**: NLP classification and incident storage
- **Increment 3**: Location capture, mapping, and email notifications
- **Increment 4**: Responder dashboard with incident viewing and status updates
- **Increment 5**: Admin panel with reporting, configuration, and user management
- **Increment 6**: Comprehensive activity logging and audit trails

1.7.5.4 Testing

Multiple testing layers ensured system reliability:

- **Unit Testing**: Verified individual functions like user registration, NLP classification, location capture, and email sending
- **Integration Testing**: Ensured smooth communication between frontend, backend, database, and external APIs
- **Functional Testing**: Validated complete workflows from alert submission to responder notification
- **User Acceptance Testing (UAT)**: Simulated users tested the emergency reporting experience and dashboard usability
- **Performance Testing**: Evaluated system response times under load
- **Security Testing**: Verified authentication, authorization, and input validation

1.7.5.5 Deployment and Maintenance

Each increment was deployed to a staging environment for testing. Once approved, it was deployed to the production server environment. Deployment involved configuring the PHP backend, setting up the MySQL database, and hosting the platform on a secure web server with HTTPS. Ongoing maintenance includes bug fixes based on user feedback, performance optimization, and security updates.

Chapter 2
PROBLEM DEFINITION

2.1 Problem Statement

The main problem addressed by this project is the inefficiency and delay in communication during emergencies. Vital information such as location, severity, and type of crisis often fails to reach responders quickly, causing slower response times and increased risk to life and property. Emergency agencies frequently use fragmented tools and manual processes, leading to confusion and poor coordination in critical moments.

Citizens reporting emergencies face several challenges:

- **Difficulty describing location** accurately under stress
- **Long wait times** on emergency hotlines
- **No confirmation** that their report has been received
- **No visibility** into response progress

Responders face complementary challenges:

- **Delayed notification** about emergencies in their area
- **Incomplete or inaccurate information** about incident nature and location
- **Lack of situational awareness** about multiple concurrent incidents
- **No centralized platform** for tracking incident statuses

The Crisis Alert System solves these problems by providing an integrated, automated solution that streamlines emergency alerts through rapid message classification, automatic location capture, instant responder notification, and a centralized coordination dashboard for real-time incident monitoring and management.

2.2 Deliverables Requirements

2.2.1 Crisis Alert System Platform

This is the primary software product: a web-based application built with PHP, JavaScript, MySQL, and NLP libraries. The platform offers:

- **NLP-Based Message Classification**: Automatically analyzes emergency text to determine crisis type (Fire, Accident, Medical, Natural Disaster, Other) and severity
- **Automatic Location Capture**: Captures user's GPS coordinates via browser geolocation and converts them to readable addresses
- **Real-Time Incident Mapping**: Displays active incidents on interactive maps with color-coded markers
- **Emergency Alert Submission**: Simple form for citizens to report emergencies quickly
- **User Authentication**: Secure registration and login for citizens, responders, and administrators

- **Role-Based Access Control**: Different permissions for citizens, responders, and admins
- **Responder Dashboard**: Centralized interface for monitoring incidents and updating statuses
- **Email Notifications**: Automated alerts to all registered responders when incidents are reported
- **Incident Status Management**: Update incident statuses (Pending, In-Progress, Resolved) and add remarks
- **Admin Panel**: Manage users, configure system settings, generate reports
- **Reporting and Analytics**: Generate incident reports by type, status, and time period
- **Activity Logging**: Complete audit trail of all system actions

2.2.2 Documentation

User Documentation (Citizen Guide): This documentation is aimed at citizens who will report emergencies through the Crisis Alert System. It provides clear, step-by-step instructions for creating an account (if required), accessing the emergency submission form, typing an emergency message, granting location permission, and submitting the report. It also explains what to expect after submission and how to check incident status (future enhancement).

Responder Documentation: This guide is tailored for emergency responders who will use the dashboard to monitor and manage incidents. It covers logging into the responder account, navigating the dashboard, viewing incidents on map and list views, filtering incidents by type and status, viewing incident details, updating incident statuses, and adding remarks.

Technical Documentation: This document is for developers and technical stakeholders. It outlines the system architecture, backend logic (PHP), frontend components (HTML/CSS/JS), database schema (MySQL), NLP classification algorithm, API integrations (Google Maps, SMTP), source code structure, and deployment instructions.

Admin Guide: Created for platform administrators, this guide explains how to manage users (create, edit, delete, assign roles), configure system settings (responder email lists, notification templates, crisis types), generate reports, review audit logs, and perform routine maintenance.

2.2.3 Testing Reports

This section includes comprehensive documentation of all testing procedures and results: well-defined test cases for each functional module (inputs, expected outcomes, actual outcomes), unit testing reports, integration testing reports, functional testing reports, performance testing results, security testing results, and user acceptance testing (UAT) feedback.

2.2.4 Deployment Setup

The deployment section details the process of releasing the Crisis Alert System to a live server. It includes steps for configuring the production environment (web server with PHP 7.4+, MySQL 5.7+), setting up the database, configuring environment variables (database credentials, SMTP settings, Google Maps API key), and optimizing for performance and security. The deployment process ensures the site is accessible to citizens and responders with proper monitoring.

2.3 Development Requirements

2.3.1 Technologies and Tools - Frontend

- **HTML5**: For page structure and semantic markup
- **CSS3**: For styling, layout, and responsive design
- **Bootstrap 5**: For responsive UI components and grid system
- **JavaScript (ES6+)**: For client-side interactivity, form validation, and AJAX calls
- **Leaflet.js / Google Maps API**: For interactive map display and geocoding
- **Fetch API / Axios**: For asynchronous frontend-backend communication

2.3.2 Technologies and Tools - Backend

- **PHP 7.4+**: Server-side scripting language for application logic
- **MySQL 5.7+**: Relational database for data storage (users, incidents, logs)
- **PDO (PHP Data Objects)**: For secure database access and parameterized queries
- **Apache / Nginx**: Web server for hosting the application
- **PHPMailer / SwiftMailer**: For sending email notifications via SMTP
- **Composer**: Dependency management for PHP packages

2.3.3 Server and Hosting Requirements

The platform is designed for deployment on shared hosting or VPS environments with:

- PHP 7.4 or higher with extensions: PDO, MySQL, OpenSSL, cURL, JSON, mbstring
- MySQL 5.7 or higher
- Apache 2.4+ or Nginx
- SSL certificate for HTTPS (required for geolocation API)
- SMTP server access for email notifications

2.3.4 Performance and Scalability

- Page load time under 3 seconds on standard broadband connections
- NLP classification completes within 2 seconds per message
- Dashboard loads with real-time incident data; refresh interval configurable
- Database queries optimized with indexes on frequently queried columns (user_id, incident status, timestamp)
- Support for concurrent users: at least 50 simultaneous sessions
- Scalable architecture: database and application layers separable for future cloud deployment

2.3.5 Security and Privacy

- **Password Hashing**: All user passwords hashed using PHP's password_hash() function (bcrypt algorithm)
- **Prepared Statements**: All database queries use PDO prepared statements to prevent SQL injection
- **Input Validation**: All user inputs validated and sanitized on server side
- **Output Escaping**: HTML output escaped to prevent XSS attacks
- **CSRF Protection**: Tokens implemented on all forms
- **Session Security**: Secure session configuration (HTTP-only, secure flag in production)
- **HTTPS Enforcement**: All traffic encrypted via SSL/TLS
- **Role-Based Access Control**: Strict permissions for citizens, responders, and admins
- **Data Minimization**: Only necessary user data collected and stored

Table 2.3.6: Development Milestones

Phase	Duration	Activities
Phase 1	Week 1-2	Requirements gathering, stakeholder interviews, literature review, wireframing
Phase 2	Week 3-5	Database design, user authentication, basic alert submission form
Phase 3	Week 6-8	NLP classification engine integration, location capture, map display
Phase 4	Week 9-11	Notification system (email), responder dashboard development
Phase 5	Week 12-14	Admin panel, reporting, audit logging, system configuration
Phase 6	Week 15-16	Comprehensive testing (unit, integration, functional, performance, security)
Phase 7	Week 17-18	Documentation completion, deployment, user training, final presentation

2.3.7 Collaboration and Version Control

- **Git** for distributed version control
- **GitHub** for remote repository hosting and team collaboration
- **Branching strategy**: Feature branches for each module, merged to develop branch after testing, main branch for production releases
- **Issue tracking**: GitHub Issues for bug tracking and feature requests
- **Project management**: Weekly team meetings and progress tracking

2.4 Current System

At present, emergency response in many regions relies heavily on:

- **Telephone hotlines** (e.g., 15 for police, 1122 for medical emergencies in Pakistan)
- **Basic web forms** on police or municipal websites
- **Social media** (Twitter, Facebook) used unofficially for reporting
- **Manual dispatch systems** where operators log calls on paper or basic software

Table 2.4.1 significant limitations:

Aspect	Current Systems	Limitations
Alert Submission	Phone calls only	Long wait times, no visual interface, no location automation
Location Information	User describes verbally	Prone to error, imprecise, time-consuming
Message Classification	Manual by dispatcher	Subject to human error, inconsistent, slow
Responder Notification	Phone call to responder	Single point of failure, no audit trail, delayed
Incident Tracking	Paper log or basic spreadsheet	No real-time visibility, difficult to search/analyze
Coordination	Radio or phone between agencies	Fragmented communication, no shared situational awareness
Reporting	Manual compilation	Time-consuming, error-prone, delayed

The Crisis Alert System addresses these limitations by providing an integrated digital platform that automates alert classification, captures precise locations, notifies responders instantly, and provides real-time shared visibility through an interactive dashboard.

Chapter 3
REQUIREMENT ANALYSIS

3.1 Use Case Diagram

The Use case diagram for the Crisis Alert System illustrates the interaction between three primary actors: **Citizen (User)**, **Responder**, and **Administrator**. This diagram provides a comprehensive overview of system functionalities available to each role.

Citizens can:

- Register a new account
- Log into the system
- Submit emergency alerts (including text message and location)
- View submission confirmation

Responders can:

- Log into the system
- View all active incidents on dashboard (map and list views)
- Filter incidents by type and status
- View detailed incident information
- Update incident status (Pending, In-Progress, Resolved)
- Add remarks to incidents
- Receive email notifications about new incidents

Administrators have all responder permissions plus:

- Manage users (create, edit, delete, assign roles)
- Configure system settings (responder email lists, notification templates)
- Generate reports (incident statistics, response times)
- View audit logs (system activity trail)
- Manage crisis type definitions

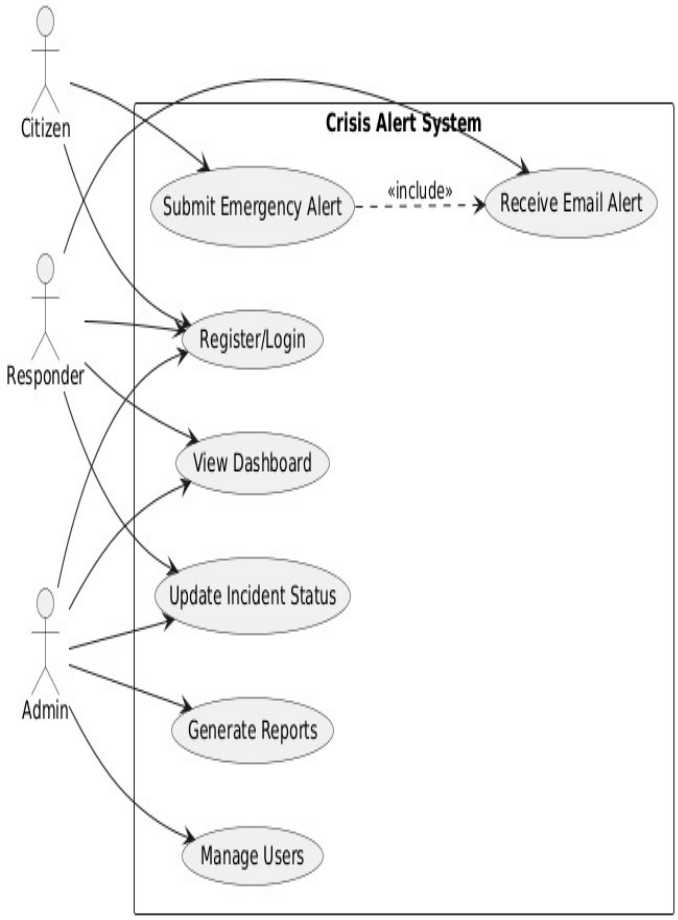

Figure 3.1-1: Use Case Diagram

3.2 Functional Requirements

Table 3.2.1: User Module (Citizen)

ID	Requirement	Priority
FR-01	The system shall allow users to register using email and password	High
FR-02	The system shall hash passwords before storing in database	High
FR-03	The system shall allow users to log in with email and password	High
FR-04	The system shall validate login credentials and display appropriate error messages	High
FR-05	The system shall allow users to submit emergency alerts via a web form	High
FR-06	The system shall require at least 10 characters of descriptive text for emergency messages	Medium
FR-07	The system shall capture user's GPS coordinates using browser	High

	geolocation when permitted	
FR-08	The system shall display a confirmation message after successful alert submission	Medium
FR-09	The system shall display error messages for incomplete or invalid submissions	Medium

Table 3.2.2: Responder Module

ID	Requirement	Priority
FR-10	The system shall provide a dashboard displaying all active incidents	High
FR-11	The dashboard shall display incidents on an interactive map with markers	High
FR-12	The dashboard shall display incidents in a list/card view with key details	High
FR-13	Responders shall be able to filter incidents by crisis type	Medium
FR-14	Responders shall be able to filter incidents by status (Pending, In-Progress, Resolved)	Medium
FR-15	Responders shall be able to view complete details of any incident	High
FR-16	Responders shall be able to update incident status (Pending, In-Progress, Resolved)	High
FR-17	Responders shall be able to add remarks to incidents	Medium
FR-18	The system shall automatically notify all responders via email when new incidents are submitted	High

Table 3.2.3: Admin Module

ID	Requirement	Priority
FR-19	Admin shall be able to view all registered users	High
FR-20	Admin shall be able to add new users and assign roles	High
FR-21	Admin shall be able to edit user details (name, email, role)	High
FR-22	Admin shall be able to delete user accounts	High
FR-23	Admin shall be able to configure responder email lists	Medium
FR-24	Admin shall be able to configure notification templates	Medium
FR-25	Admin shall be able to generate incident reports by type, status, and	Medium

	date range	
FR-26	Admin shall be able to view system audit logs including user actions	Medium
FR-27	Admin shall be able to manage crisis type	Low

3.3 Non-Functional Requirements

3.3.1 Usability

The system must have an intuitive, easy-to-navigate interface suitable for users of all technical backgrounds. The emergency submission form shall be designed for completion in under 30 seconds. Clear visual feedback (success messages, error messages, loading indicators) shall be provided for all user actions. The interface must be responsive and fully functional on desktops, tablets, and smartphones.

3.3.2 Performance

The system shall process and classify 95% of submitted alerts within 5 seconds under normal network conditions. The dashboard shall display incidents in real-time without requiring manual page refresh (auto-refresh interval ≤ 30 seconds). Page load time shall be under 3 seconds on standard broadband connections. The system shall support at least 50 concurrent user sessions without performance degradation.

3.3.3 Security

All user passwords shall be securely hashed (bcrypt) before storage. All database queries shall use prepared statements to prevent SQL injection. All user inputs shall be validated and sanitized on the server side. Role-based access control shall restrict unauthorized access to sensitive functions. HTTPS shall be used for all data transmission in production. Session cookies shall use HTTP-only and Secure flags.

3.3.4 Portability

The system shall be deployable on any standard web hosting environment supporting PHP 7.4+ and MySQL 5.7+. The codebase shall be well-documented to facilitate migration to different servers. The system shall be compatible with major web browsers (Chrome, Firefox, Edge, Safari) and their mobile equivalents.

3.3.5 Reliability

The system shall maintain 99% availability during operational hours. Unsent email notifications shall be queued for automatic retry in case of temporary SMTP failures. The database shall maintain referential integrity through foreign key constraints

3.3.6 Maintainability

The system shall follow modular design with clear separation of concerns between frontend, backend, and database layers. Code shall follow consistent naming conventions and include inline comments for complex logic. The system architecture shall support independent updates to individual modules without affecting others.

3.3.7 Scalability

The database schema shall support horizontal scaling. The backend logic shall be structured to allow migration to cloud hosting (e.g., AWS, Azure) with minimal code changes. As incident volume increases, additional server resources can be provisioned without architectural changes.

3.3.8 Compatibility

The web application shall be compatible with modern browsers: Google Chrome (latest 2 versions), Mozilla Firefox (latest 2 versions), Microsoft Edge (latest 2 versions), and Safari (latest 2 versions). It shall function properly on Windows, macOS, Android, and iOS devices. The system shall integrate seamlessly with Google Maps API for geocoding and mapping, and SMTP servers for email notifications.

Chapter 4
DESIGN AND ARCHITECTURE

4.1 System Architecture

The Crisis Alert System follows a modular, three-tier layered architecture designed to ensure scalability, maintainability, and clear separation of responsibilities. Each component operates independently but communicates through defined interfaces.

Architecture Layers:

1. **Presentation Layer (Frontend)** - HTML5, CSS3, Bootstrap, JavaScript

- User Interface for citizens (alert submission form)
- Responder Dashboard (map, incident list, status controls)
- Admin Panel (user management, reporting, configuration)
- Handles user input, displays data, communicates with backend via AJAX/HTTP

2. **Application Logic Layer (Backend)** - PHP

- User authentication and session management
- Emergency message processing and NLP classification
- Location data handling and geocoding
- Incident record creation and storage
- Notification engine (email dispatch)
- Dashboard data aggregation
- Admin configuration and reporting logic
- Audit logging

3. **Database Layer** - MySQL

- Stores users, incidents, locations, notifications, logs
- Enforces data integrity through constraints
- Provides efficient querying through indexes

4. **External Services Layer**

- Google Maps API (geocoding, reverse geocoding, map display)
- SMTP Service (email notifications)

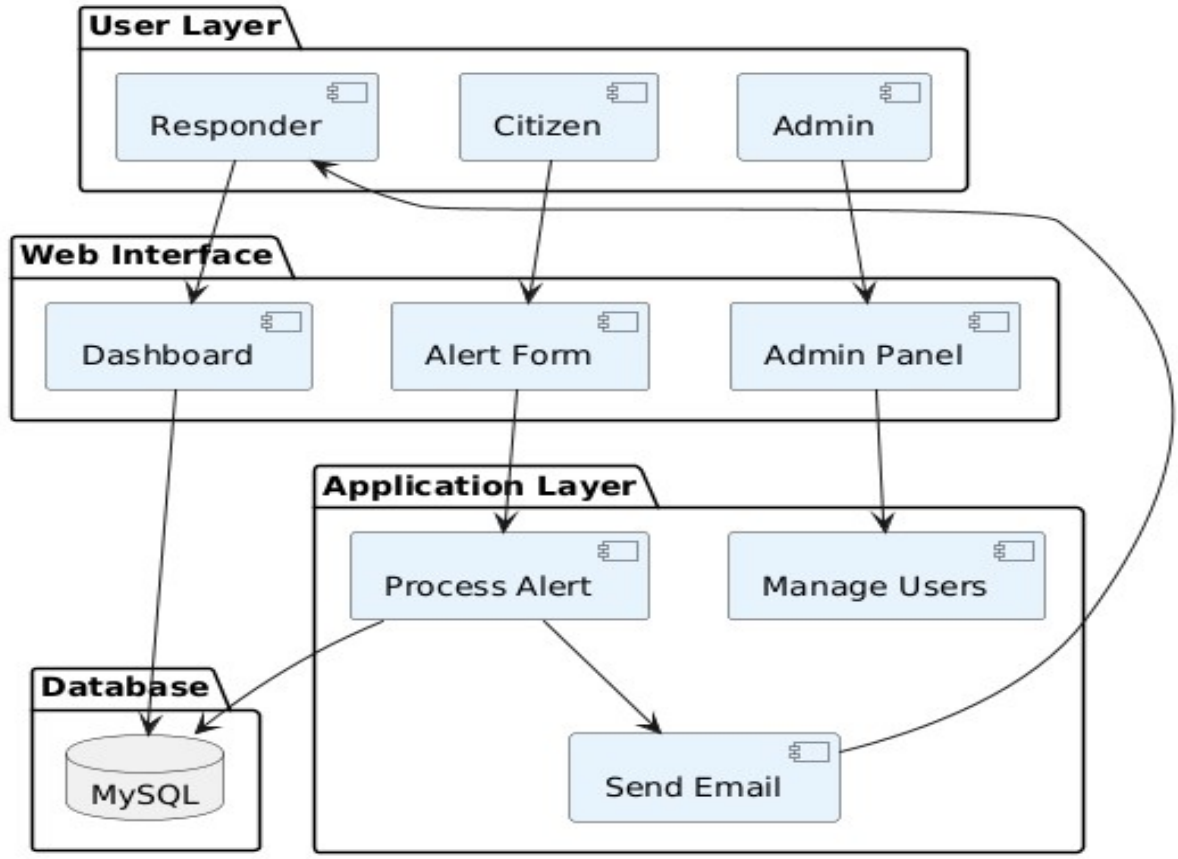

Figure 4.1-1: System Architecture Diagram

4.2 Data Representation

The Crisis Alert System uses a relational database model with MySQL for structured data storage. Each core entity is stored in a dedicated table with clearly defined primary and foreign keys, ensuring data integrity and efficient querying.

Key Tables:

- incidents - Emergency users - User authentication and profile data
- incident records
- locations - Geographic coordinates and addresses
- notifications - Log of email alerts sent
- logs - System activity audit trail

The database schema is normalized to third normal form (3NF) to reduce redundancy and maintain consistency.

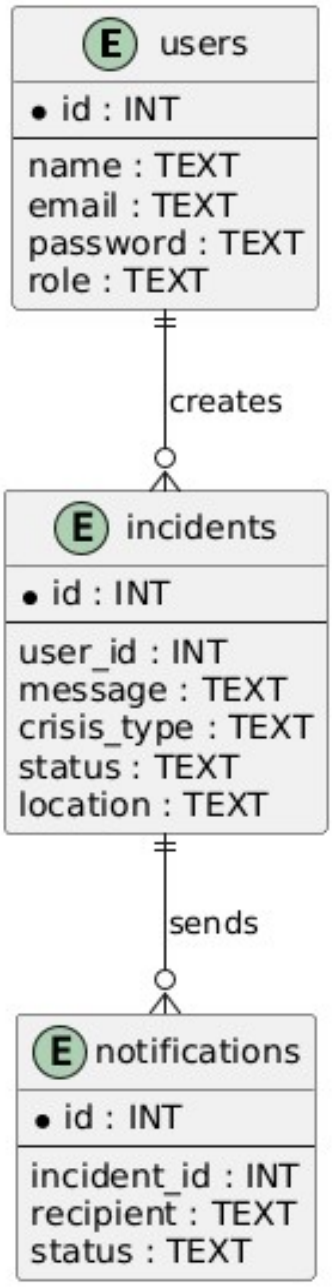

Figure 4.2-1: Entity Relationship Diagram

4.3 Process Flow/Representation

The process flow begins when a citizen submits an emergency alert through the web interface. The PHP backend receives the message, performs NLP-based classification to identify crisis type, captures location via browser geolocation, creates an incident record in the database, and automatically dispatches email notifications to all registered responders. The incident is then immediately visible on the responder dashboard (both map and list views) where responders can update its status as they address the emergency.

4.3.1 Activity Diagrams

Activity diagrams model the dynamic behavior of the system, showing sequential decisions and concurrent workflows.

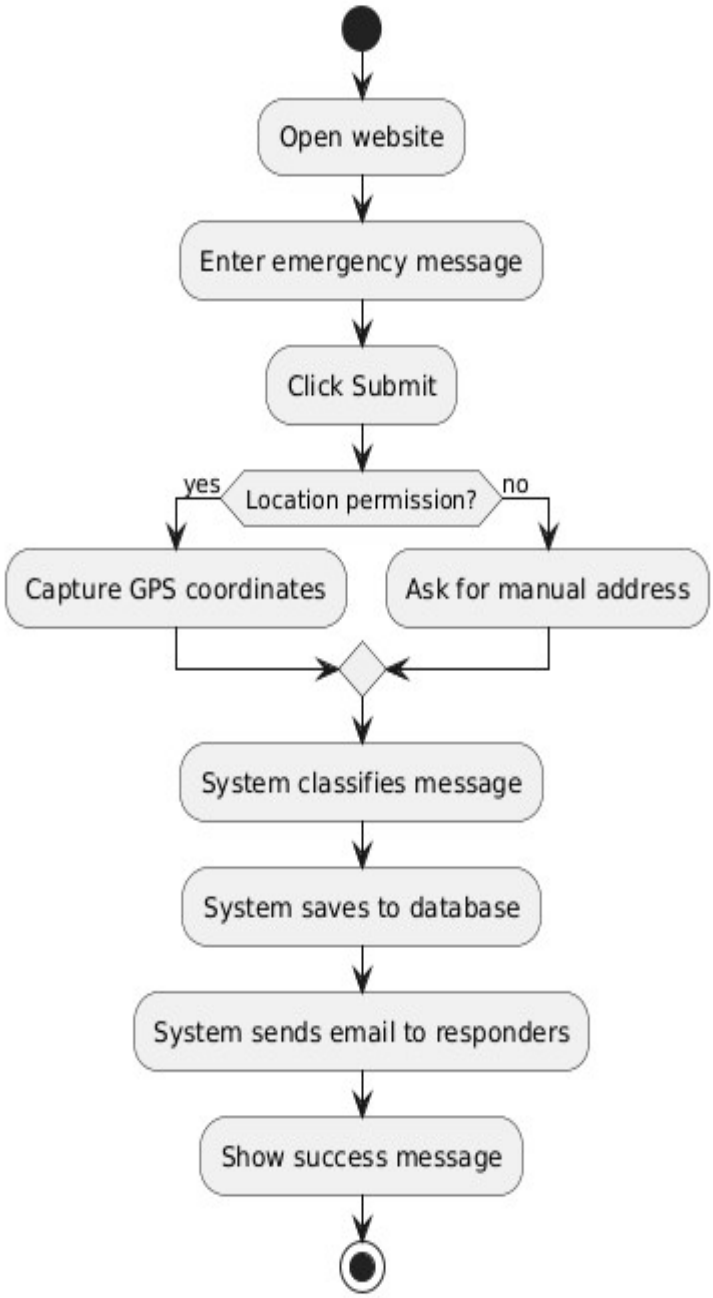

Figure 4.3-1: Citizen Activity Diagram

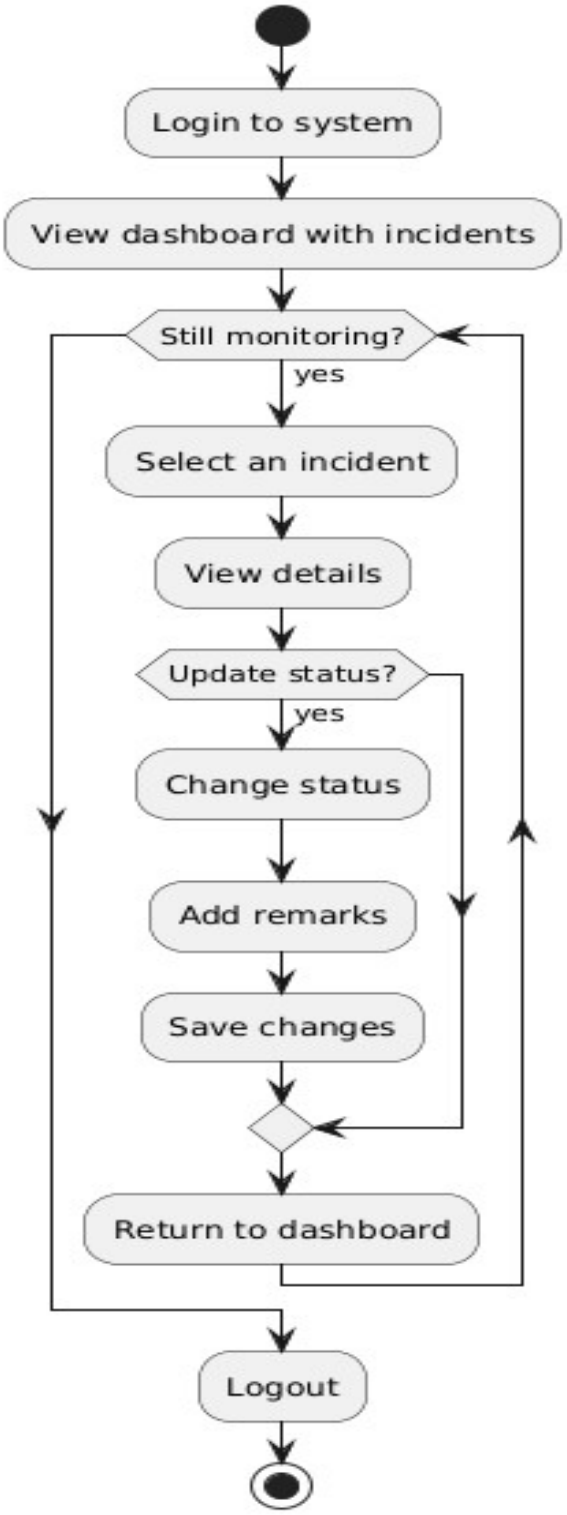

Figure 4.3-2: Responder Activity Diagram

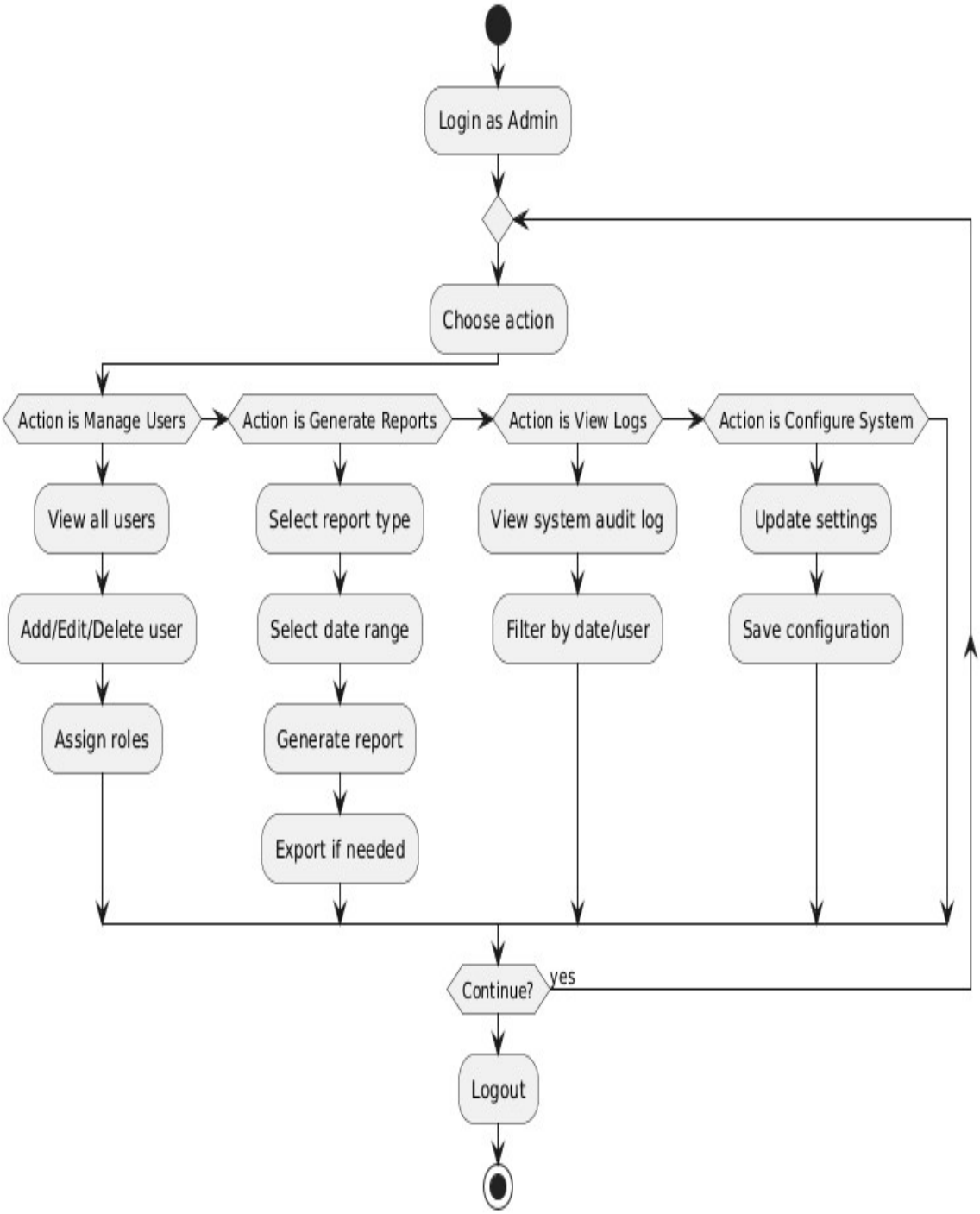

Figure 4.3-3: Admin Activity Diagram

4.4 Process Flow Diagram

The Process Flow Diagram (PFD) provides a high-level overview of the entire operation, showing how user inputs move through processing stages to final outputs.

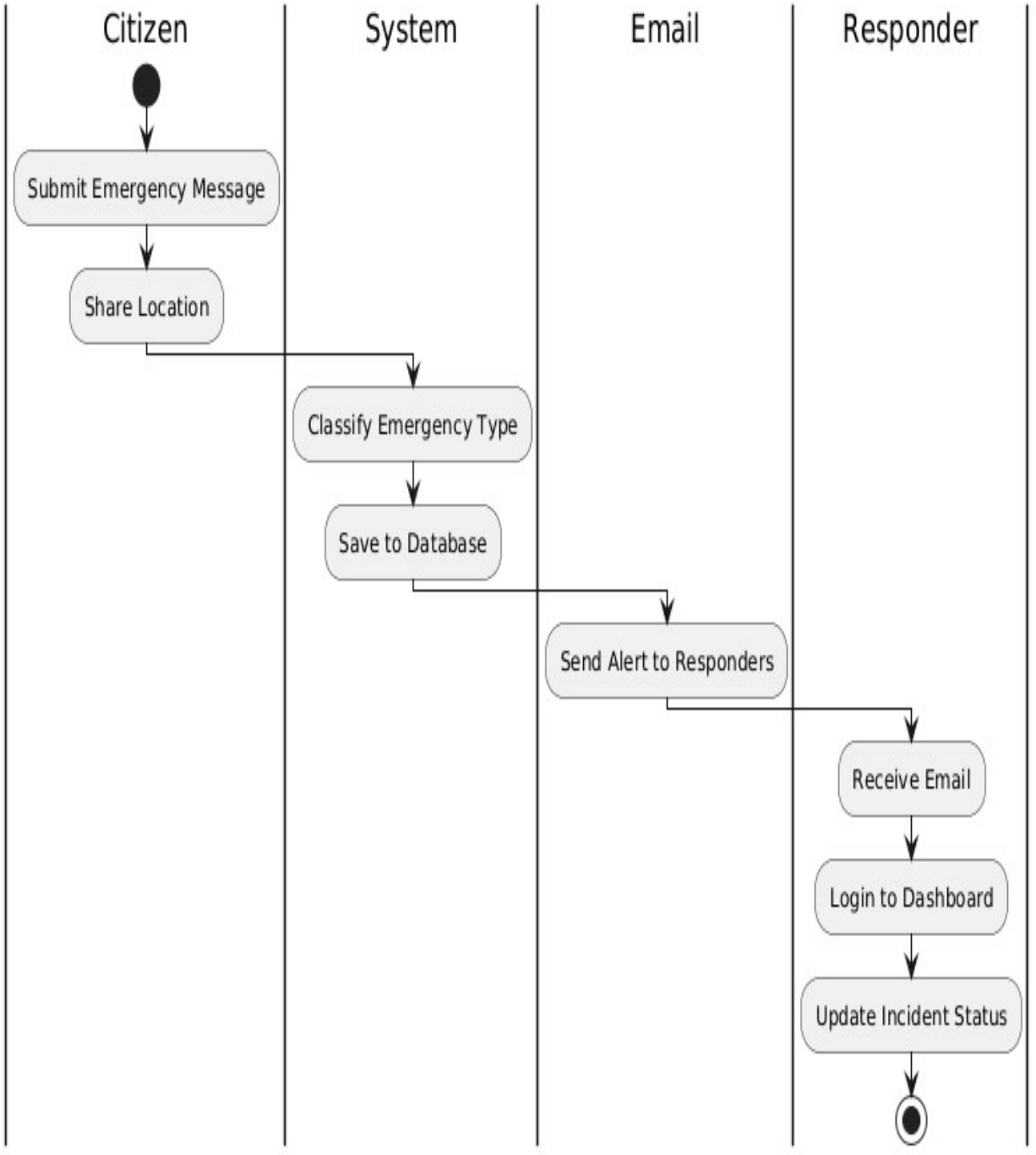

Figure 4.4-1: Process Flow Diagram

4.5 Design Models

4.5.1 Class Diagram

The class diagram illustrates the static structure of the Crisis Alert System, showing classes, attributes, methods, and relationships.

Core Classes:

- **User** (abstract base class) - Attributes: id, name, email, password, role, created_at; Methods: register(), login(), logout(), updateProfile()
- **Citizen** (extends User) - Methods: submitEmergency()
- **Responder** (extends User) - Methods: viewDashboard(), updateIncidentStatus(), addRemarks()
- **Admin** (extends User) - Methods: manageUsers(), generateReports(), configureSystem(), viewLogs()
- **Incident** - Attributes: id, userId, message, type, severity, latitude, longitude, address, status, createdAt, updatedAt; Methods: createIncident(), classifyMessage(), updateStatus()
- **Location** - Attributes: id, incidentId, latitude, longitude, address; Methods: getCoordinates(), reverseGeocode()
- **Notification** - Attributes: id, incidentId, recipientEmail, subject, body, sentAt, status; Methods: sendEmail(), logNotification()
- **Dashboard** - Methods: displayIncidents(), filterIncidents(), updateMap()
- **Report** - Attributes: type, dateRange, data; Methods: generateReport(), exportData()
- **AuditLog** - Attributes: id, userId, action, timestamp, details; Methods: logAction()

Relationships:

- **Inheritance**: Citizen, Responder, Admin extend User
- **Composition**: Incident contains Location (if incident deleted, location deleted)
- **Aggregation**: Dashboard displays multiple Incidents
- **Association**: Notification is associated with Incident; User creates Incident

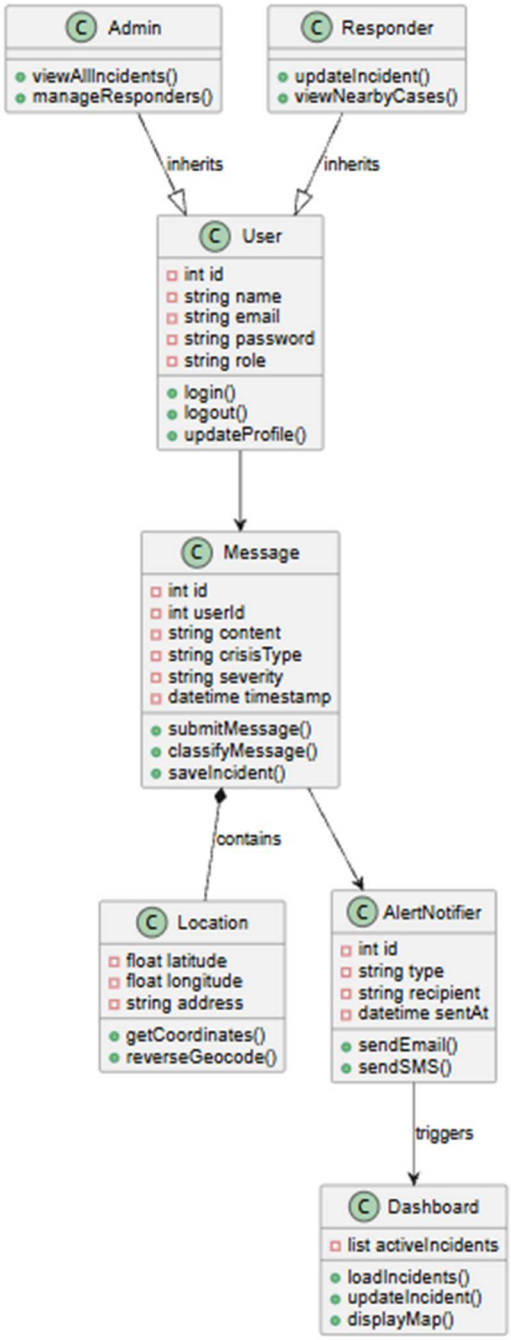

Figure 4.5-1: Class Diagram

4.5.2 Sequence Diagram

The sequence diagram illustrates the dynamic interaction between objects during an emergency submission.

Actors/Objects: Citizen, Browser, System (UI), IncidentController, NLPService, LocationService, Database, NotificationService, Responder (email)

Steps:

1. Citizen submits emergency message
2. Browser requests location permission and retrieves coordinates
3. System UI sends data to IncidentController
4. IncidentController calls NLPService to classify message
5. NLPService returns type and severity
6. IncidentController calls LocationService with coordinates
7. LocationService returns formatted address
8. IncidentController saves incident to Database
9. Database returns success with incident ID
10. IncidentController triggers NotificationService to send email alerts
11. NotificationService sends emails to all Responders
12. System UI displays confirmation to Citizen
13. (Parallel) Responder receives email and views dashboard

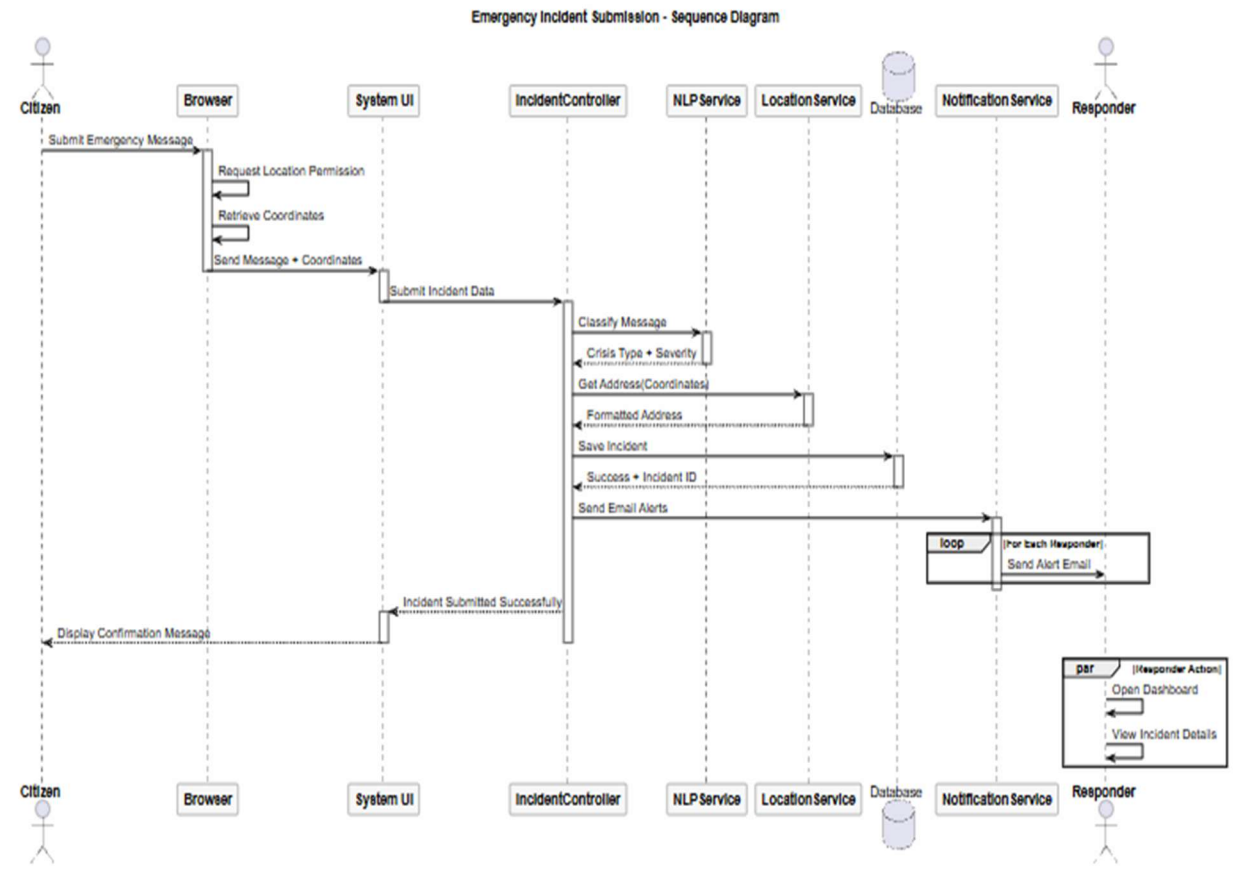

Figure 4.5-2: Sequence Diagram

4.5.3 Data Flow Diagram (DFD)

Level 0 DFD (Context Diagram): Shows system as single process with external entities: Citizen, Responder, Admin, Email Service, Google Maps API.

Level 1 DFD: Decomposes main process into sub-processes:

- 1.0 User Authentication
- 2.0 Process Emergency Alert
- 3.0 Classify Message (NLP)
- 4.0 Capture Location
- 5.0 Store Incident
- 6.0 Send Notifications
- 7.0 Manage Dashboard
- 8.0 Generate Reports
- 9.0 Manage Users (Admin)
- 10.0 Log Activity

Data Stores: D1 Users, D2 Incidents, D3 Locations, D4 Notifications, D5 Logs

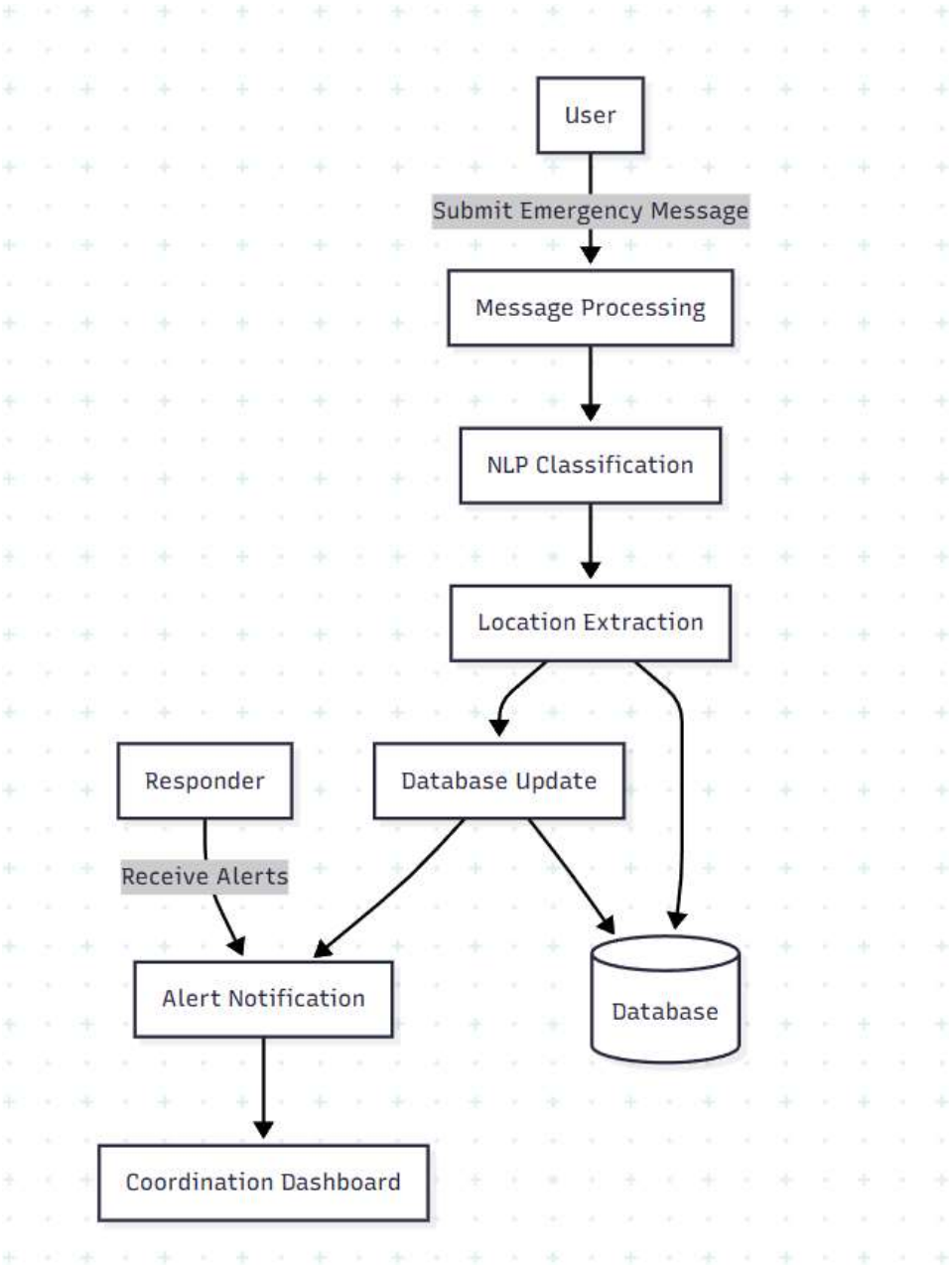

Figure 4.5.3: Data Flow Diagram

4.6 Data Design

4.6.1 Data Dictionary

Table 4-1: users Table Schema

Field	Type	Null	Key	Description
id	INT(11)	NO	PRI	Unique user identifier (auto-increment)
name	VARCHAR(100)	NO		User's full name
email	VARCHAR(100)	NO	UNI	Unique email address for login
password	VARCHAR(255)	NO		Hashed password (bcrypt)
role	ENUM('citizen','responder','admin')	NO		User role for access control
created_at	DATETIME	YES		Account creation timestamp

Table 4-2: incidents Table Schema

Field	Type	Null	Key	Description
id	INT(11)	NO	PRI	Unique incident identifier
user_id	INT(11)	NO	FK	User who submitted (references users.id)
message	TEXT	NO		Full emergency message text
crisis_type	VARCHAR(50)	YES		Classified type (fire/accident/medical/disaster/other)
severity	INT(11)	YES		Severity score (1-5, higher=more severe)
latitude	VARCHAR(50)	YES		GPS latitude coordinate
longitude	VARCHAR(50)	YES		GPS longitude coordinate
address	VARCHAR(255)	YES		Human-readable address
status	ENUM('pending','in-progress','resolv	NO	'pending'	Current incident status

	ed')			
created_at	DATETIME	YES		Submission timestamp
updated_at	DATETIME	YES		Last status update timestamp

Table 4-3: Notifications Table Schema

Field	Type	Null	Key	Description
id	INT(11)	NO	PRI	Unique notification identifier
incident_id	INT(11)	NO	FK	Related incident (references incidents.id)
recipient_email	VARCHAR(100)	NO		Email address of recipient
subject	VARCHAR(255)	NO		Email subject line
body	TEXT	NO		Email body content
sent_at	DATETIME	YES		Timestamp when email was sent
status	ENUM(sent)	NO	'sent'	Delivery status

Table 4-4: logs Table Schema

Field	Type	Null	Key	Description
id	INT(11)	NO	PRI	Unique log entry identifier
user_id	INT(11)	YES	FK	User who performed action (references users.id, NULL for system actions)
action	VARCHAR(255)	NO		Description of action performed
incident_id	INT(11)	YES	FK	Related incident (if applicable)
ip_address	VARCHAR(45)	YES		User's IP address at time of action

Chapter 5
IMPLEMENTATION

5.1 Algorithms

This section presents the pseudocode for core system algorithms.

5.1.1 User Authentication Algorithm

```
FUNCTION authenticateUser(email, password)
INPUT email, password
CONNECT TO database
PREPARE SELECT query: "SELECT * FROM users WHERE email = :email"
EXECUTE query with email parameter
FETCH userRecord
IF userRecord EXISTS THEN
IF password_verify(password, userRecord.hashed_password) THEN
START user session
SET session variables: user_id, user_name, user_role
RETURN SUCCESS with user_role
ELSE
RETURN FAILURE "Invalid password"
END IF
ELSE
RETURN FAILURE "User not found"
END IF
END FUNCTION
FUNCTION registerUser(name, email, password, role = 'citizen')
INPUT name, email, password, role
VALIDATE email format and password strength
CHECK if email already exists in database
IF email exists THEN
RETURN FAILURE "Email already registered"
END IF
hashPassword = password_hash(password, PASSWORD_BCRYPT)
CONNECT TO database
PREPARE INSERT query: "INSERT INTO users (name, email, password, role, created_at)
VALUES (:name, :email, :password, :role, NOW())"
```

EXECUTE query with parameters
IF insert successful THEN
RETURN SUCCESS "User registered successfully"
ELSE
RETURN FAILURE "Registration failed"
END IF
END FUNCTION

5.1.2 Emergency Message Processing Algorithm

FUNCTION processEmergencyAlert(userId, message, locationAllowed, latitude, longitude)
INPUT userId, message, locationAllowed, latitude, longitude
// Step 1: Validate input
IF message length < 10 THEN
RETURN FAILURE "Message must be at least 10 characters"
END IF
// Step 2: Classify message using NLP
classificationResult = classifyEmergencyMessage(message)
crisisType = classificationResult.type
severity = classificationResult.severity
// Step 3: Process location
IF locationAllowed = true AND latitude IS NOT NULL THEN
address = reverseGeocode(latitude, longitude)
ELSE
latitude = NULL
longitude = NULL
address = "Location not detected"
END IF
// Step 4: Store incident in database
CONNECT TO database
PREPARE INSERT query: "INSERT INTO incidents
(user_id, message, crisis_type, severity, latitude, longitude, address, status, created_at)
VALUES (:user_id, :message, :crisis_type, :severity, :latitude, :longitude, :address, 'pending', NOW())"
EXECUTE query with parameters

```
incidentId = LAST_INSERT_ID()
// Step 5: Send notifications to responders
sendAlertsToResponders(incidentId, message, crisisType, address)
// Step 6: Log action
logAction(userId, "Submitted emergency alert", incidentId)
RETURN SUCCESS with incidentId
END FUNCTION
```

5.1.3 NLP-Based Crisis Classification Algorithm

```
FUNCTION classifyEmergencyMessage(message)
INPUT message
// Step 1: Preprocessing
messageText = toLowercase(message)
messageText = removePunctuation(messageText)
tokens = tokenize(messageText)  // Split into words
// Step 2: Keyword matching
fireKeywords = ["fire", "burning", "smoke", "flame", "blaze", "burn"]
accidentKeywords = ["accident", "crash", "collision", "wreck", "hit", "rammed"]
medicalKeywords = ["medical", "heart", "attack", "injury", "bleeding", "unconscious", "stroke",
"breathing", "emergency"]
disasterKeywords = ["earthquake", "flood", "storm", "hurricane", "tornado", "landslide", "tsunami"]
// Step 3: Count keyword matches per category
fireScore = countKeywordMatches(tokens, fireKeywords)
accidentScore = countKeywordMatches(tokens, accidentKeywords)
medicalScore = countKeywordMatches(tokens, medicalKeywords)
disasterScore = countKeywordMatches(tokens, disasterKeywords)
// Step 4: Determine type with highest score
scores = [fireScore, accidentScore, medicalScore, disasterScore]
maxScore = max(scores)
IF maxScore == 0 THEN
type = "other"
ELSE IF maxScore == fireScore THEN
type = "fire"
ELSE IF maxScore == accidentScore THEN
```

type = "accident"

ELSE IF maxScore == medicalScore THEN

type = "medical"

ELSE IF maxScore == disasterScore THEN

type = "natural_disaster"

END IF

// Step 5: Calculate severity (1-5)

urgencyKeywords = ["urgent", "critical", "emergency", "severe", "immediately", "life threatening"]

urgencyScore = countKeywordMatches(tokens, urgencyKeywords)

severity = 1 + min(4, floor((maxScore + urgencyScore) / 2))

RETURN type, severity

END FUNCTION

5.1.4 Location Extraction and Mapping Algorithm

FUNCTION captureAndStoreLocation()

// Client-side (JavaScript) - Browser geolocation

IF browser supports geolocation THEN

TRY

CALL navigator.geolocation.getCurrentPosition()

ON success(position):

latitude = position.coords.latitude

longitude = position.coords.longitude

SEND latitude, longitude to server via AJAX

CALL reverseGeocode(latitude, longitude) to get address

UPDATE map display with marker at coordinates

RETURN SUCCESS with coordinates and address

ON error(permissionDenied):

PROMPT user to enter address manually

RETURN "Manual entry required"

ELSE

PROVIDE manual address input field

END IF

FUNCTION reverseGeocode(latitude, longitude)

CALL Google Maps Geocoding API with latitude, longitude

PARSE JSON response

address = response.results[0].formatted_address

RETURN address

END FUNCTION

5.1.5 Database CRUD Operations

FUNCTION saveIncidentToDatabase(incidentData)

CONNECT TO database using PDO

PREPARE INSERT query

BIND parameters

EXECUTE query

IF execution success THEN

RETURN lastInsertId()

ELSE

LOG error

RETURN FALSE

END IF

END FUNCTION

FUNCTION updateIncidentStatus(incidentId, newStatus, responderId)

CONNECT TO database

PREPARE UPDATE query: "UPDATE incidents SET status = :status, updated_at = NOW() WHERE id = :id"

EXECUTE query with parameters

LOG action: responderId updated incidentId status to newStatus

IF update success THEN

RETURN TRUE

ELSE

RETURN FALSE

END IF

END FUNCTION

FUNCTION fetchAllIncidents(filters = [])

CONNECT TO database

Build SELECT query with optional WHERE clauses based on filters

IF filters contains 'status' THEN

Add "WHERE status = :status"

END IF

IF filters contains 'type' THEN

Add "WHERE crisis_type = :type"

END IF

ORDER BY created_at DESC

EXECUTE query

RETURN all matching incidents

END FUNCTION

5.1.6 Alert Notification Algorithm

FUNCTION sendAlertsToResponders(incidentId, message, crisisType, locationAddress)

CONNECT TO database

// Fetch all responder emails

QUERY: "SELECT id, name, email FROM users WHERE role = 'responder' OR role = 'admin'"

responders = executeQuery()

// Construct email content

subject = "EMERGENCY ALERT: " + strtoupper(crisisType) + " Reported"

body = "A " + crisisType + " emergency has been reported.\n\n"

body = body + "Details:\n"

body = body + "Message: " + message + "\n"

body = body + "Location: " + locationAddress + "\n"

body = body + "Time: " + now() + "\n"

body = body + "Incident ID: " + incidentId + "\n\n"

body = body + "Please log into the Crisis Alert System dashboard for more information and to update incident status.\n"

body = body + "Dashboard URL: https://yourdomain.com/dashboard"

FOR EACH responder IN responders:

TRY

sendEmail(responder.email, subject, body)

logNotification(incidentId, responder.email, subject, body, "sent")

CATCH emailException

logNotification(incidentId, responder.email, subject, body, "failed")

// Queue for retry (optional)

END TRY
END FOR
RETURN "Notifications sent to " + count(responders) + " recipients"
END FUNCTION

5.1.7 Dashboard Population Algorithm

FUNCTION refreshDashboardData()
CONNECT TO database
// Fetch all pending and in-progress incidents
QUERY: "SELECT * FROM incidents WHERE status IN ('pending', 'in-progress') ORDER BY created_at DESC"
activeIncidents = executeQuery()
// Fetch recent resolved incidents (last 24 hours)
QUERY: "SELECT * FROM incidents WHERE status = 'resolved' AND updated_at > DATE_SUB(NOW(), INTERVAL 24 HOUR)"
recentResolved = executeQuery()
// Prepare data for map markers
markers = []
FOR EACH incident IN activeIncidents:
IF incident.latitude IS NOT NULL THEN
marker = {
id: incident.id,
lat: incident.latitude,
lng: incident.longitude,
type: incident.crisis_type,
status: incident.status,
message: incident.message
}
markers.append(marker)
END IF
END FOR
// Prepare data for list view
incidentList = activeIncidents + recentResolved
RETURN {

```
markers: markers,
incidents: incidentList,
counts: {
pending: count(status='pending'),
inProgress: count(status='in-progress'),
resolved: count(status='resolved')
}
}
END FUNCTION
```

5.2 External APIs and Integrations

Table 5-1: External APIs and Integrations

Component	Technology / Tool	Purpose / Description
Backend Framework	PHP 7.4+	Server-side logic, request routing, database interactions, session management
NLP Classification	Custom PHP with keyword matching	Text preprocessing, keyword extraction, crisis type classification, severity scoring
Location & Mapping	Google Maps API / Leaflet	Geocoding (address to coordinates), reverse geocoding (coordinates to address), interactive map
Frontend UI	HTML5, CSS3, Bootstrap 5, JavaScript	Responsive user interface for alert submission, dashboard, maps
Database	MySQL 5.7+	Structured data storage for users, incidents, locations, notifications, logs
Authentication	PHP Sessions + password_hash()	User registration, login, password hashing (bcrypt), session management
Email Notifications	PHPMailer + SMTP	Automated email alerts to responders when incidents are reported
Security	PDO prepared statements, CSRF tokens, XSS protection	SQL injection prevention, cross-site request forgery protection, output escaping

Dashboard	AJAX + JavaScript	Real-time incident updates without page refresh
Reporting	PHP + MySQL queries	Incident statistics generation, report export (CSV/PDF - future)

5.3 User Interface Design

The Crisis Alert System user interface is designed with simplicity and usability as primary principles, ensuring that citizens can report emergencies quickly and responders can manage incidents efficiently.

5.3.1 Home Screen / Landing Page

The homepage serves as the entry point for all users, providing clear navigation options for citizens to submit alerts and for responders/admins to log into the dashboard.

Screen Elements:

- Header with logo and navigation menu
- "Report Emergency" prominent call-to-action button
- Brief description of system
- Login button for responders/admins
- Footer with contact information

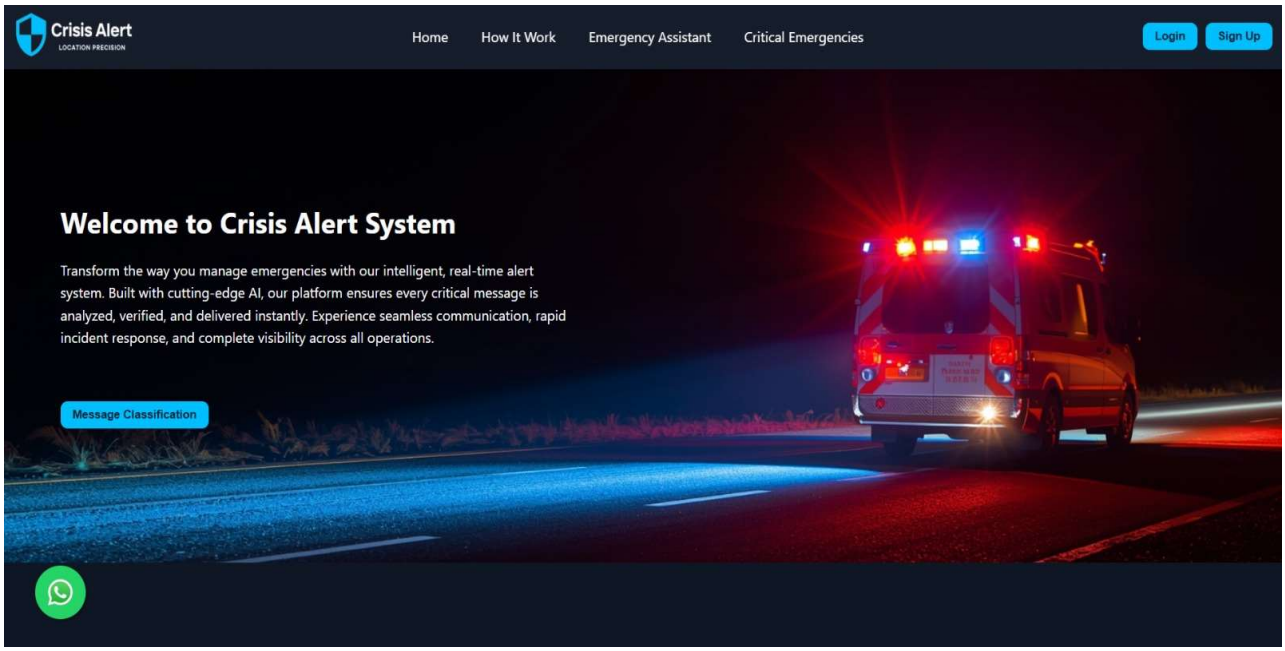

Figure 5.3-1: Home Screen

Registration Screen:

- Full name field
- Email address field
- Password field (with strength indicator)
- Confirm password field
- Register button
- Link to login page for existing users

Login Screen:

- Email field
- Password field
- Login button
- "Remember me" checkbox
- Link to registration page

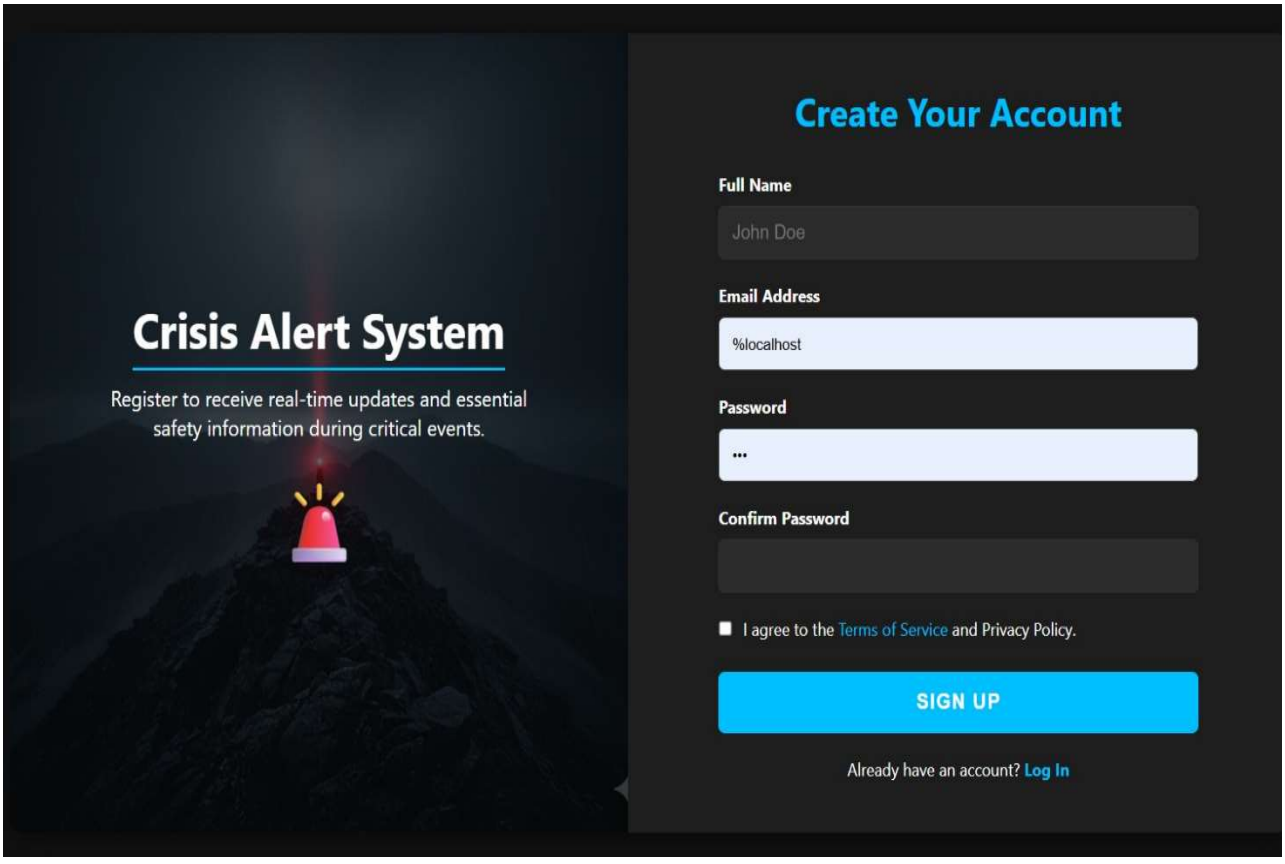

Figure 5.3-2: Registration Screen

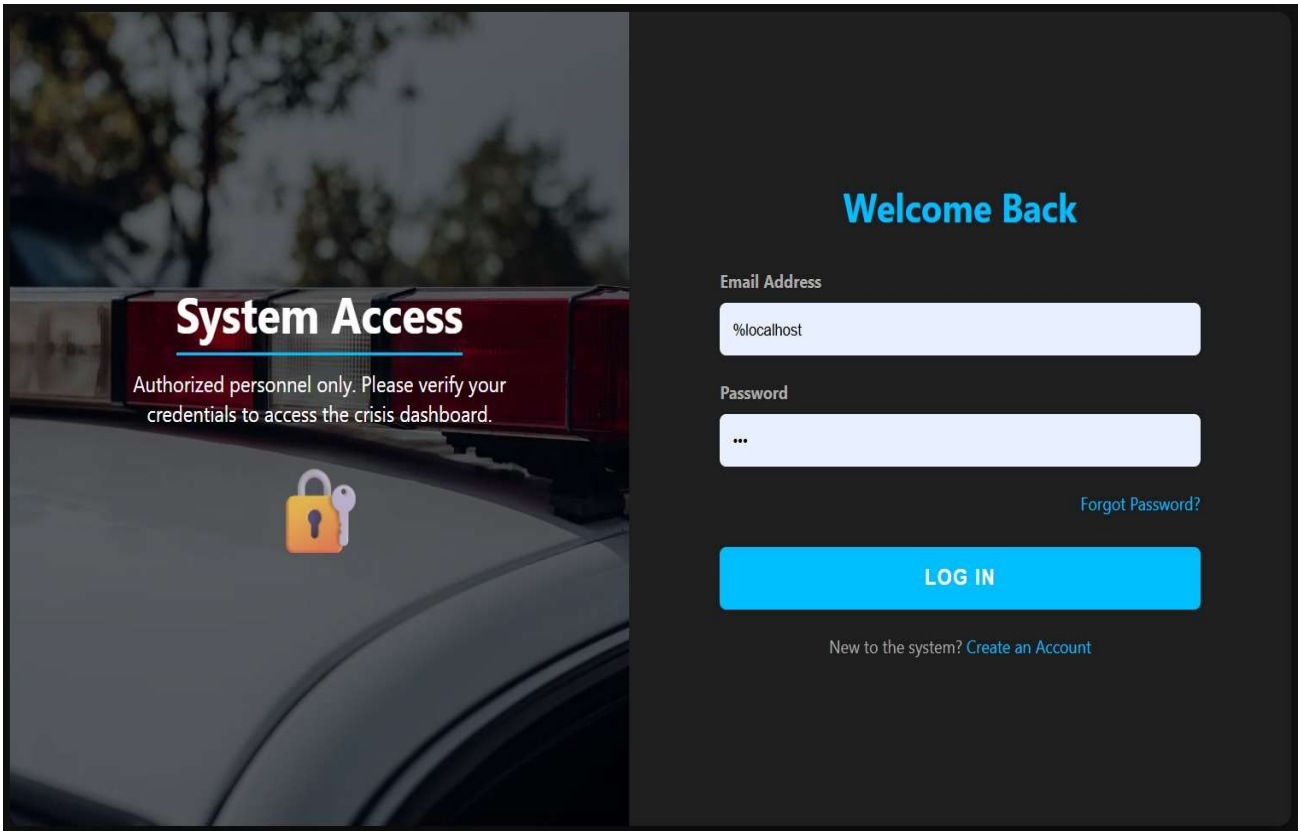

Figure 5.3-3: Login Screen

5.3.3 Emergency Alert Submission Form

The alert submission form is designed for simplicity and speed, enabling users to report emergencies in under 30 seconds.

Screen Elements:

- "Report Emergency" heading
- Textarea for emergency message (min 10 characters, character counter)
- Crisis type dropdown (optional) - Fire, Accident, Medical, Natural Disaster, Other
- Location status indicator (Waiting for permission / Location detected / Location not available)
- "Submit Emergency" prominent button

- Clear error messages for validation failures

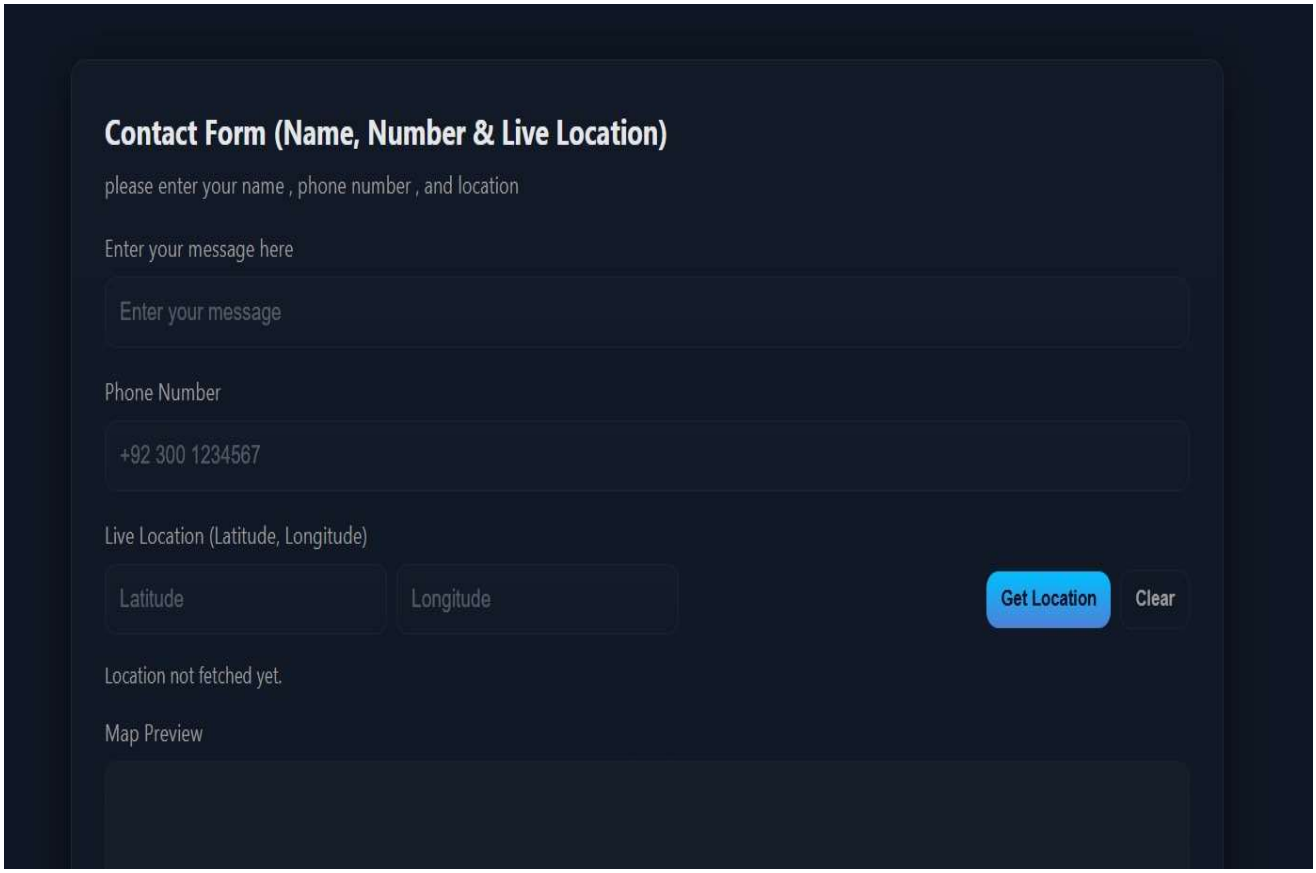

Figure 5.3-4: Emergency Alert Submission Form

5.3.4 Location Permission and Map Display

When user submits the form, browser requests location permission. If granted, the system displays their location on a map preview.

Screen Elements:

- Browser permission dialog (standard)
- Map preview showing user's location marker
- Address display showing reverse-geocoded location
- Option to manually enter address if location fails

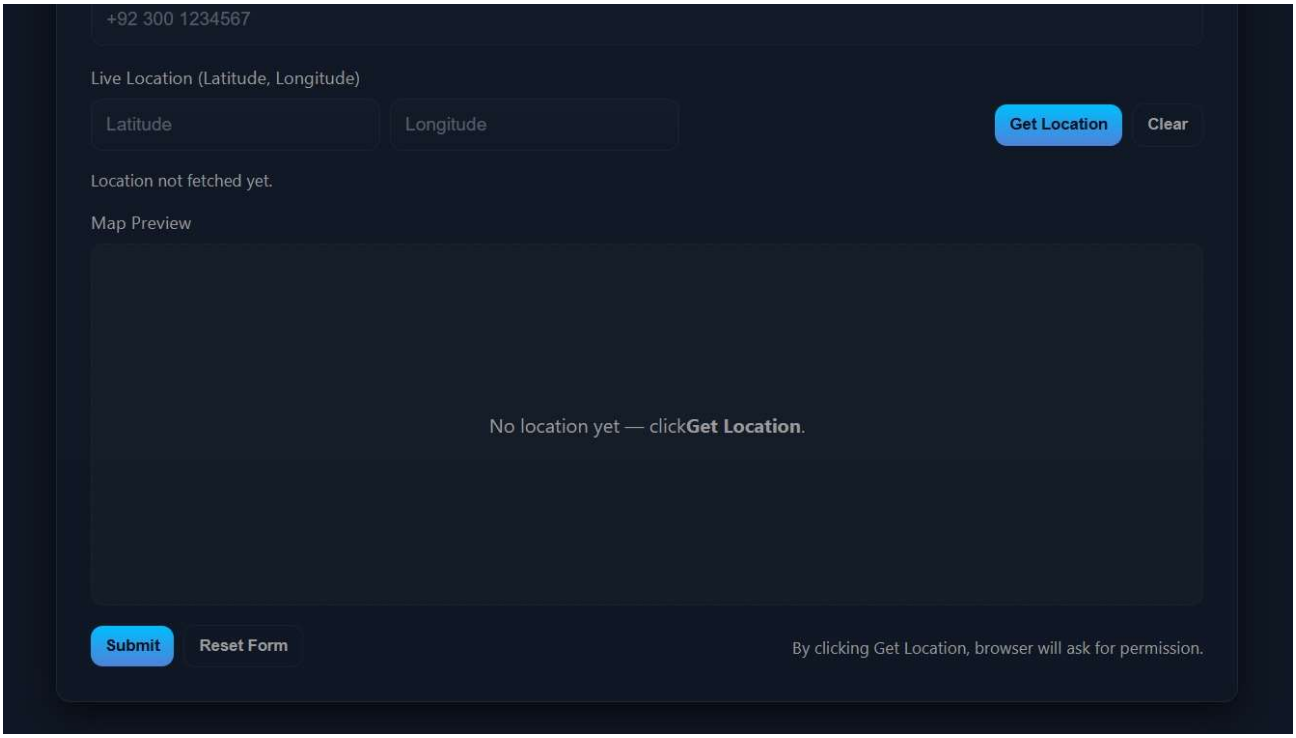

Figure 5.3-5: Location Permission Dialog

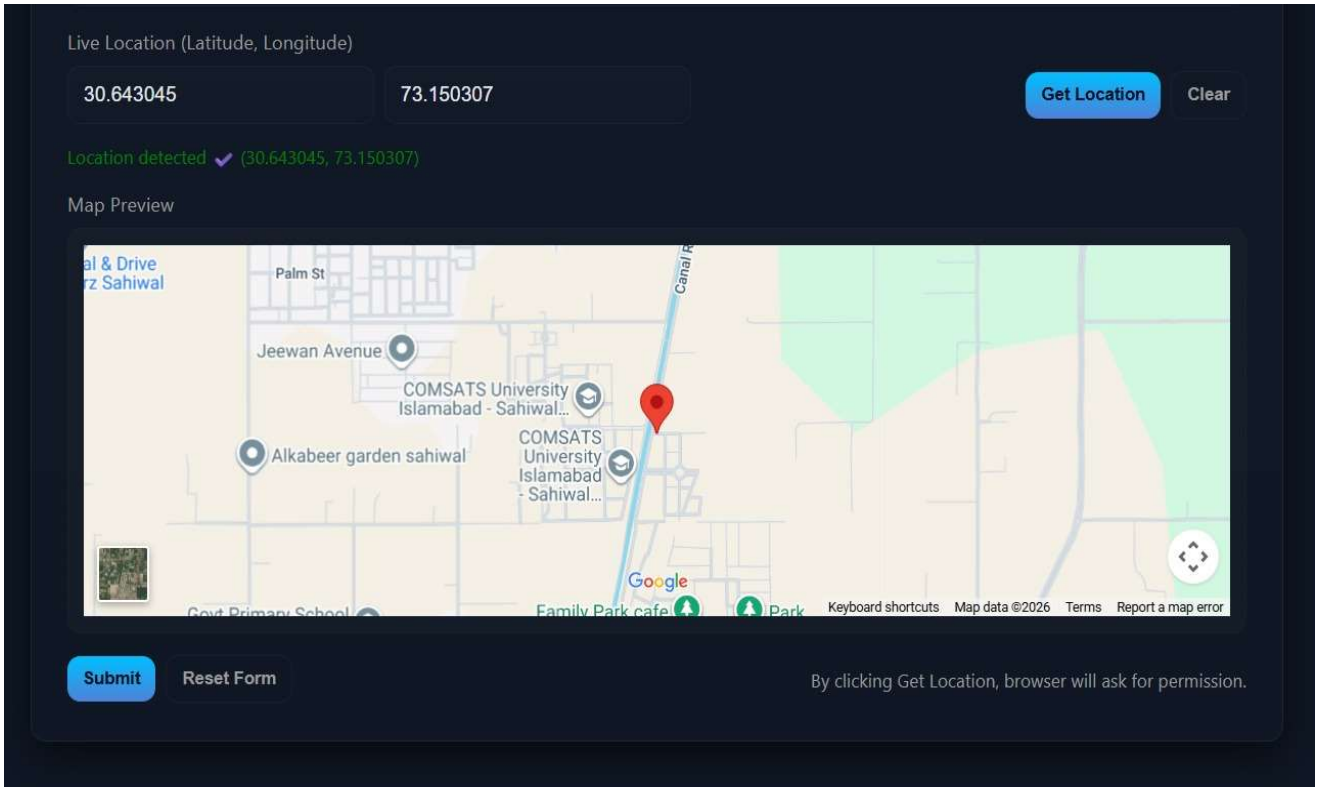

Figure 5.3-6: Map Display with User Location

5.3.5 Submission Confirmation Screen

After successful submission, the user sees a confirmation screen reassuring them that help is on the way.

Screen Elements:

- Success message: "Emergency reported successfully"
- Incident ID for reference
- Summary of submitted information (message, location)
- Message: "Responders have been notified. Help is on the way."
- Button to report another emergency (or link to home)

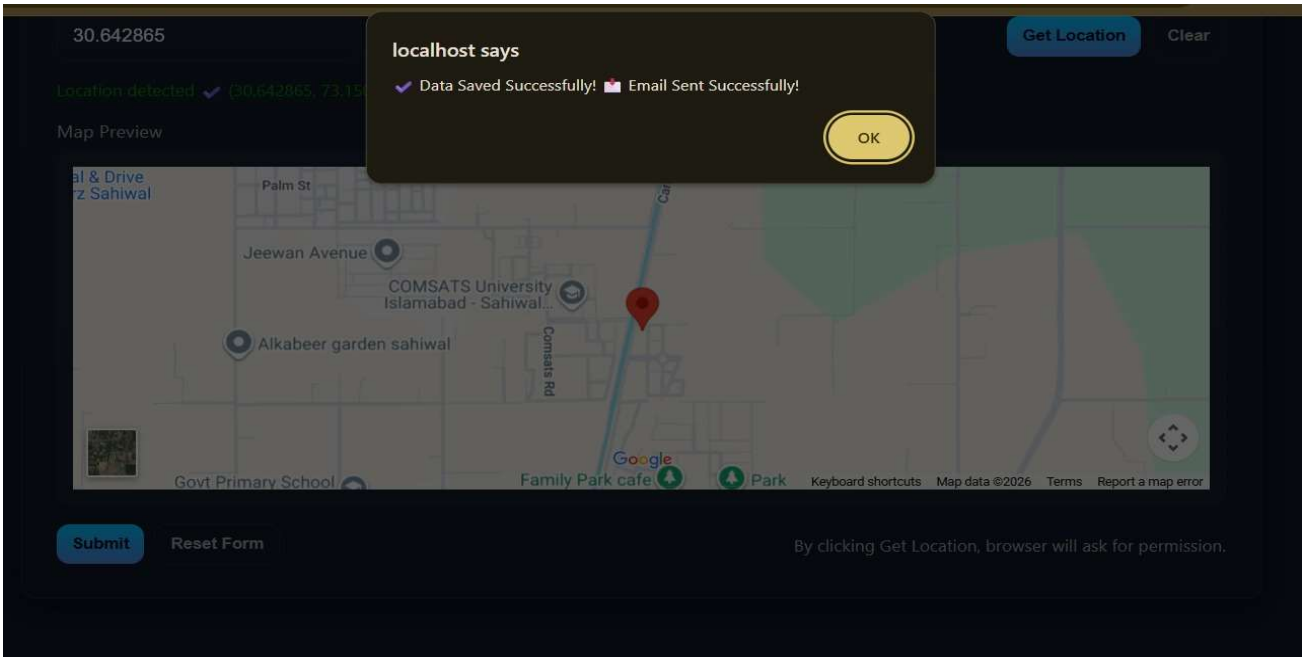

Figure 5.3-7: Submission Confirmation Screen

5.3.6 Responder Dashboard

The dashboard provides responders with real-time incident monitoring through both map and list views.

Screen Elements:

- Header with user name, role, logout button
- Statistics cards: Pending, In-Progress, Resolved (counts)
- Map view (interactive map with color-coded incident markers)
- List view (table/cards of incidents with key details)
- Filter controls: Crisis type filter, Status filter, Date range filter
- Refresh button (auto-refresh every 30 seconds)

Marker Colors: Red (Fire), Orange (Accident), Blue (Medical), Yellow (Disaster), Gray (Other)

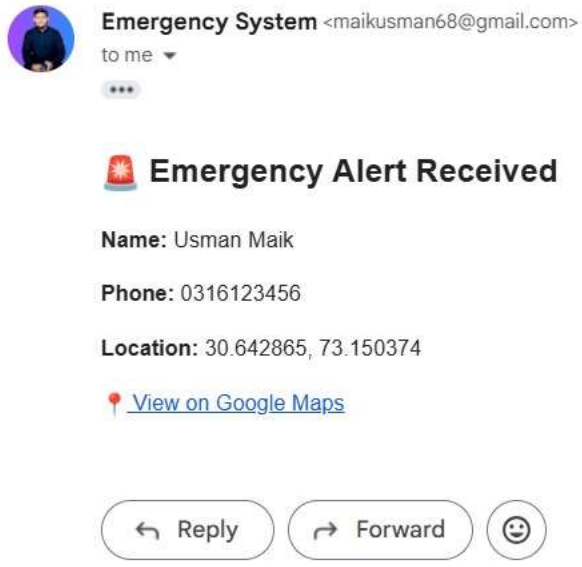

Figure 5.3-8: Responder Dashboard

5.3.7 Incident Detail View

When responder clicks on an incident (map marker or list item), detailed view opens.

Screen Elements:

- Incident ID and timestamp
- Crisis type and severity
- Full message text
- Location (address and coordinates)
- Link to open in Google Maps for navigation
- Current status badge
- Status update dropdown/buttons
- Remarks section with add remark form
- History of status changes and remarks

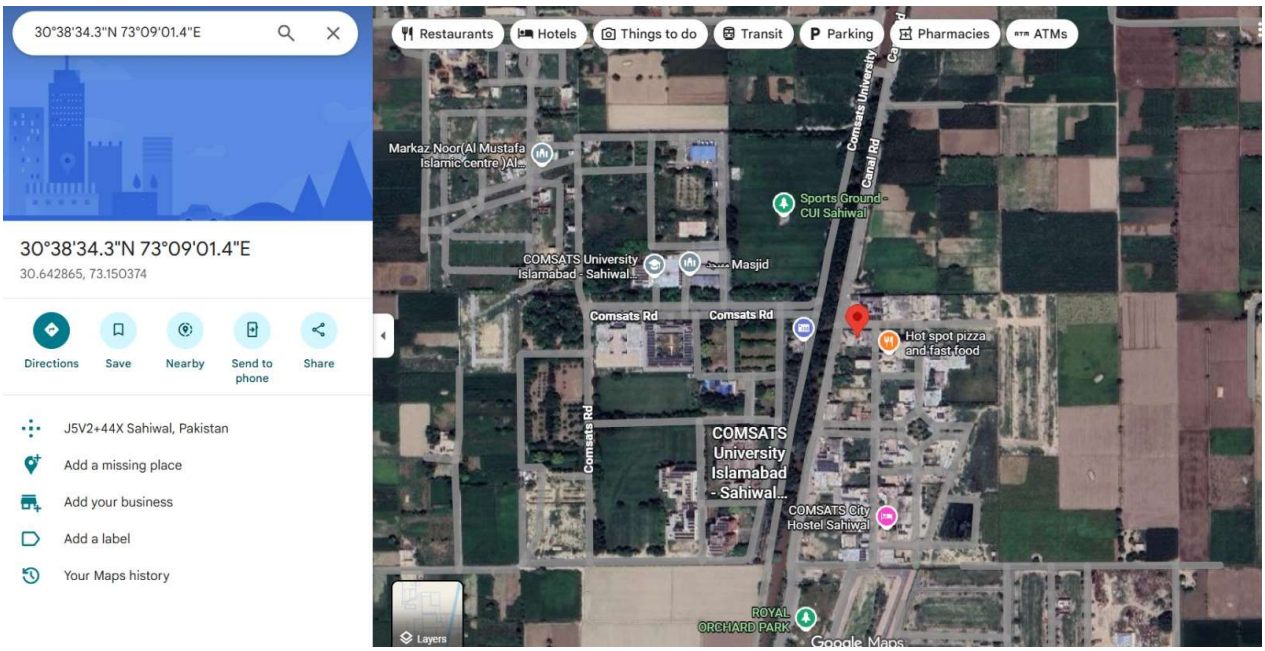

Figure 5.3-9: Incident Detail View

5.3.8 Incident Status Update Interface

Responders can update incident status through simple controls.

Screen Elements:

- Status buttons: Pending, In-Progress, Resolved (current status highlighted)
- Textarea for adding remarks/updates (optional)
- "Update Status" button
- Confirmation message on successful update

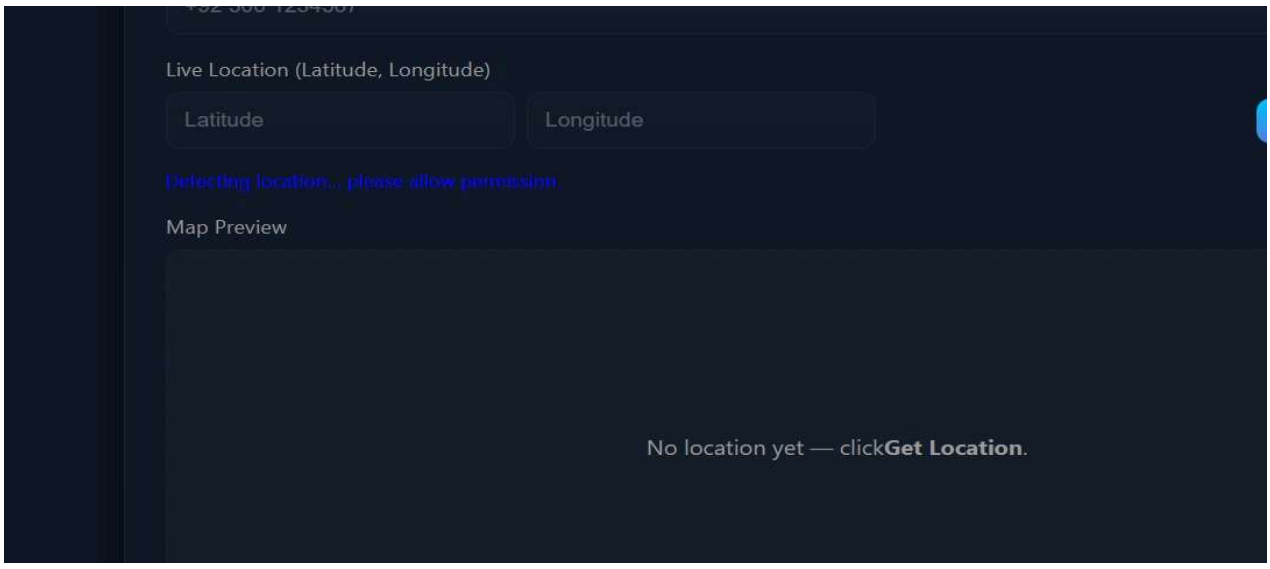

Figure 5.3-10: Incident Status Update Interface

5.3.9 Admin Panel - User Management

Administrators can manage all system users through a dedicated interface.

Screen Elements:

- User table with columns: ID, Name, Email, Role, Created Date, Actions
- "Add New User" button (opens modal/form)
- Edit icon (pencil) for each user
- Delete icon (trash) with confirmation
- Role dropdown for editing roles
- Search and filter functionality

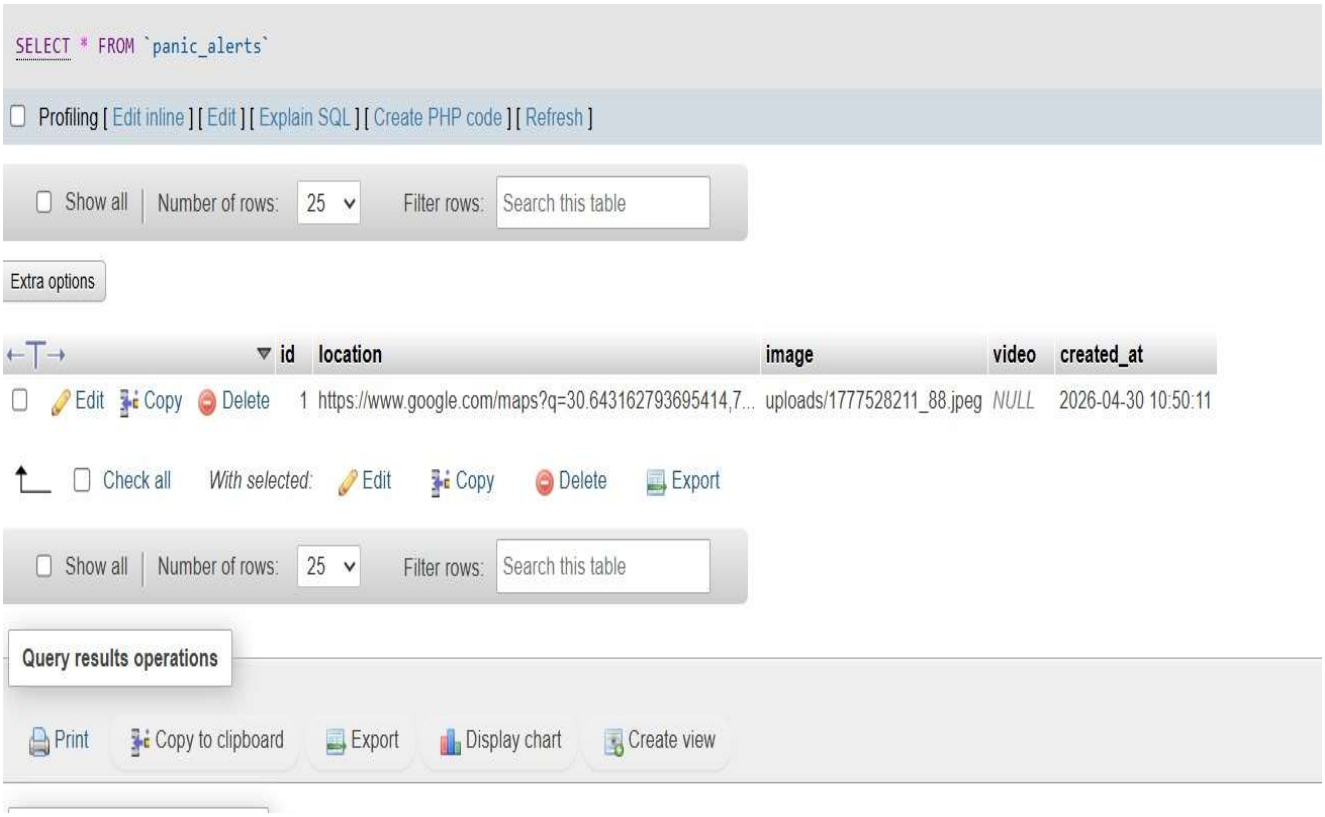

Figure 5.3-11: Admin Panel - User Management

5.3.10 Admin Panel - System Configuration

Administrators can configure system settings.

Screen Elements:

- Responder Email List (comma-separated or multi-select)
- Notification Template Editor (subject and body)
- Crisis Type Management (keywords for each type)
- Save Configuration button

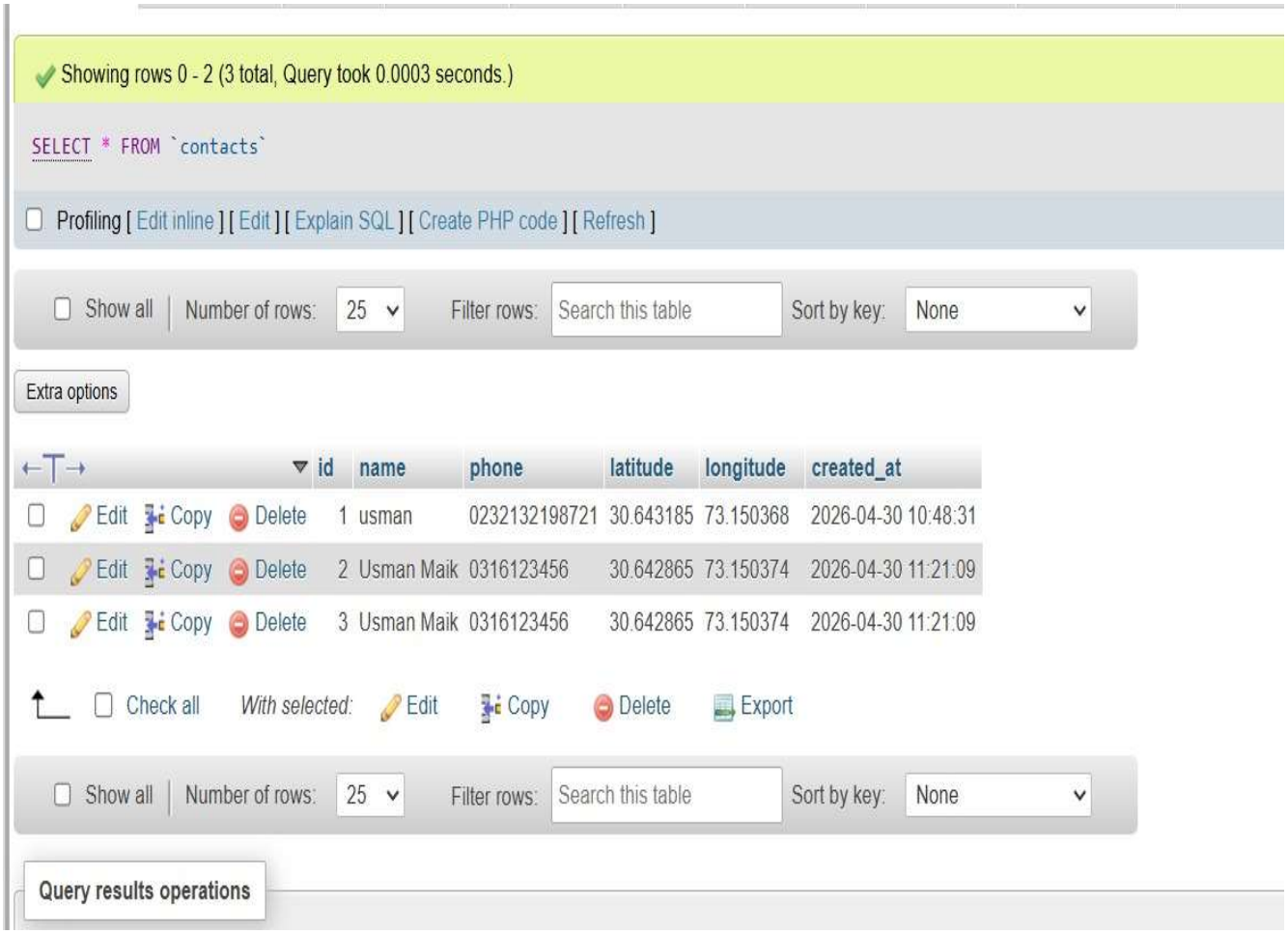

Figure 5.3-12: Admin Panel - System Configuration

5.3.11 Reporting and Analytics Dashboard

Administrators can generate reports on system activity.

Screen Elements:

- Report type selector (Incidents by Type, Response Times, User Activity, etc.)
- Date range picker
- Generate Report button
- Chart/graph display (bar charts, pie charts)
- Export buttons (CSV, PDF - future)
- Summary statistics

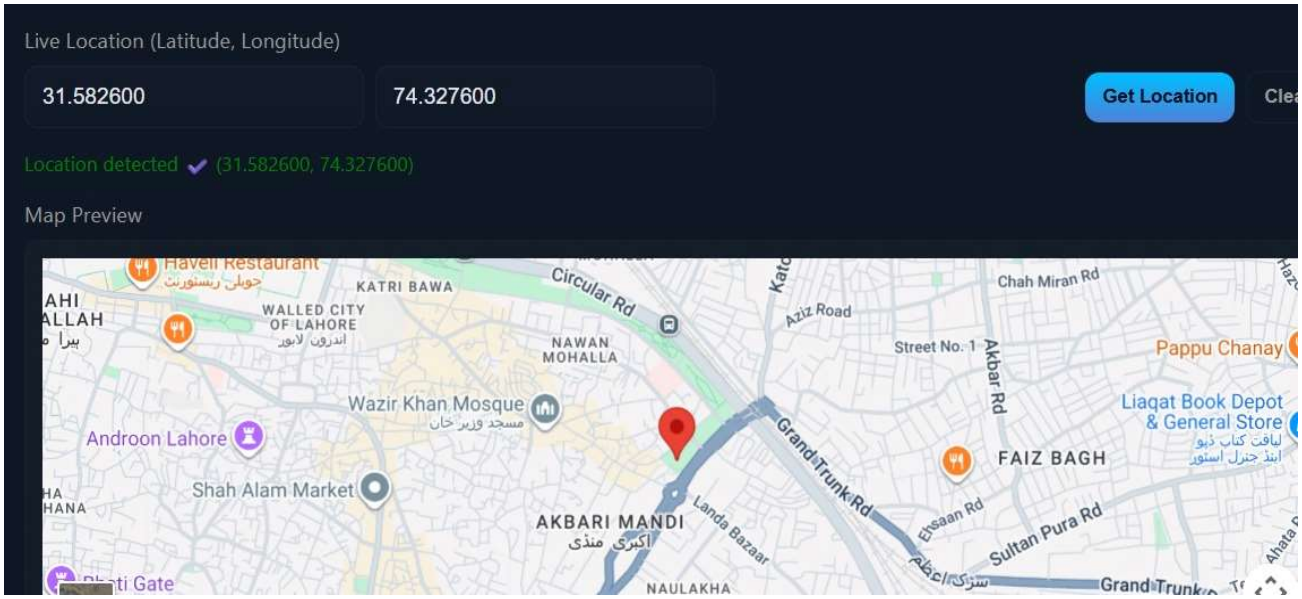

Figure 5.3-13: Reporting and Analytics Dashboard

5.3.12 Email Notification Interface

Example of email received by responders.

Email Content:

- Subject: EMERGENCY ALERT: FIRE Reported
- Body includes: emergency type, message, location, incident ID, timestamp
- Link to dashboard for details and status updates

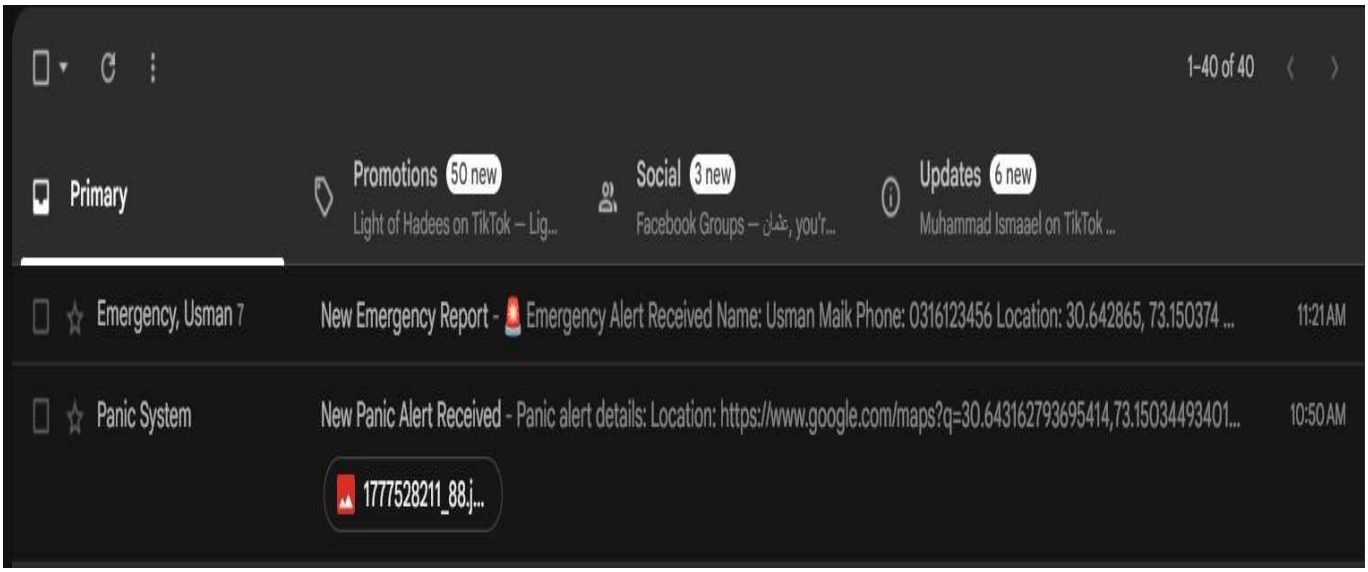

Figure 5.3-14: Email Notification Received

Chapter 6
TESTING AND EVALUATION

6.1 Testing Overview

Testing was a vital component in the development lifecycle of the Crisis Alert System, ensuring that the system functions reliably, securely, and efficiently across all user interactions. Given the system's critical nature for emergency response, rigorous testing was essential.

Testing was conducted at multiple stages:

- **Unit Testing**: During feature implementation
- **Integration Testing**: After module completion
- **Functional Testing**: For complete workflow validation
- **Performance Testing**: For system response evaluation
- **Security Testing**: For vulnerability assessment
- **User Acceptance Testing (UAT)** : Before final deployment

6.2 Unit Testing Results

Unit tests verified individual functions and components in isolation.

6.2.1 Unit Test 1: User Registration

Table 6-1: Unit Test - User Registration

Test ID	Test Case	Input	Expected Result	Actual Result	Status
UT-001	Register with valid data	name="John Doe", email="john@example.com", password="Pass@123"	User created successfully	User created	PASS
UT-002	Register with existing email	email="existing@example.com"	Error: Email already registered	Error displayed	PASS
UT-003	Register with weak password	password="123"	Error: Password too weak	Error "Password must be at least 6 characters"	PASS
UT-004	Register with invalid email	email="invalid"	Error: Invalid email format	Error displayed	PASS

6.2.2 Unit Test 2: User Login

Table 6-2: Unit Test - User Login

Test ID	Test Case	Input	Expected Result	Actual Result	Status
UT-005	Login with valid credentials	email="user@example.com", password="correct"	Login success, session created	Login successful	PASS
UT-006	Login with invalid password	email="user@example.com", password="wrong"	Error: Invalid password	Error displayed	PASS
UT-007	Login with non-existent email	email="nonexistent@example.com"	Error: User not found	Error displayed	PASS

6.2.3 Unit Test 3: Admin Login

Table 6-3: Unit Test - Admin Login

Test ID	Test Case	Input	Expected Result	Actual Result	Status
UT-008	Admin login with valid credentials	email="admin@crisissystem.com", password="admin123"	Login success, redirect to admin dashboard	Login successful	PASS
UT-009	Admin login with regular user credentials	email="user@example.com", password="userpass"	Login success but redirected to user dashboard (role-based)	Redirected correctly	PASS

6.2.4 Unit Test 4: Emergency Alert Submission

Table 6-4: Unit Test - Emergency Alert Submission

Test ID	Test Case	Input	Expected Result	Actual Result	Status
UT-010	Submit with valid message (>=10 chars)	message="There is a fire at Main Street"	Incident created, notification sent	Incident created	PASS
UT-011	Submit with short message	message="Fire"	Error: Message too short (min 10 chars)	Error displayed	PASS
UT-012	Submit without login	message="Fire emergency"	Incident created	Incident created	PASS

6.2.5 Unit Test 5: Location Detection

Table 6-5: Unit Test - Location Detection

Test ID	Test Case	Input	Expected Result	Actual Result	Status
UT-013	User grants location permission	Browser permission = Allow	Coordinates captured, address displayed	Coordinates captured	PASS
UT-014	User denies location permission	Browser permission = Block	Prompt for manual address entry	Manual entry form shown	PASS
UT-015	Reverse geocoding	latitude=30.3753, longitude=69.3451	Address returned	"Sahiwal, Pakistan" returned	PASS

6.2.6 Unit Test 6: NLP Message Classification

Table 6-6: Unit Test - NLP Message Classification

Test ID	Test Case	Input	Expected Result	Actual Result	Status
UT-016	Classify fire message	"There is a fire in the building, smoke everywhere"	type=fire, severity=4	fire, severity=4	PASS
UT-017	Classify accident message	"Car accident on highway, two vehicles"	type=accident, severity=3	accident, severity=3	PASS
UT-018	Classify medical message	"Heart attack, need ambulance immediately"	type=medical, severity=5	medical, severity=5	PASS
UT-019	Classify unknown message	"I need help"	type=other, severity=1	other, severity=1	PASS

6.2.7 Unit Test 7: Email Notification Dispatch

Table 6-7: Unit Test - Email Notification Dispatch

Test ID	Test Case	Input	Expected Result	Actual Result	Status
UT-020	Send notification when incident created	Incident ID=1, message="Fire"	Email sent to all responders (verified in sent folder)	Email received	PASS
UT-021	No notification when SMTP fails (simulated)	SMTP server down	Log entry created, retry queued	Log entry created	PASS

6.2.8 Unit Test 8: Incident Status Update

Table 6-8: Unit Test - Incident Status Update

Test ID	Test Case	Input	Expected Result	Actual Result	Status
UT-022	Update status from pending to in-progress	incidentId=1, status="in-progress"	Database updated, change reflected in dashboard	Status updated	PASS
UT-023	Update status to resolved	incidentId=1, status="resolved", remarks="Patient taken to hospital"	Status updated, remarks saved	Both saved	PASS

6.3 Functional Testing

Functional testing validated complete workflows from end to end.

Table 6-9: Functional Test - Complete Emergency Reporting Flow

Test ID	Test Case	Steps	Expected Result	Actual Result	Status
FT-001	Citizen reports emergency	1. Citizen opens site 2. Clicks "Report Emergency" 3. Types message "Fire at 123 Main St" 4. Grants location permission 5. Clicks Submit	1. Location captured 2. Message classified as FIRE 3. Incident saved 4. Email sent to responders 5. Confirmation shown	All steps successful	PASS

6.4 Integration Testing

Integration testing ensured smooth communication between system components.

Table 6-12: Integration Test - Frontend-Backend Communication

Test ID	Test Case	Components Integrated	Expected Result	Actual Result	Status
IT-001	AJAX form submission	Frontend JS + PHP endpoint	Form data sent via AJAX, JSON response received	Successful communication	PASS
IT-002	Dashboard data loading	Frontend JS + PHP + MySQL	Dashboard fetches incidents via AJAX, displays correctly	Data loaded and displayed	PASS

Table 6-13: Integration Test - Database Integration

Test ID	Test Case	Components Integrated	Expected Result	Actual Result	Status
IT-003	Incident save	PHP + MySQL	Incident record inserted into incidents table	Record saved	PASS
IT-004	User authentication	PHP + MySQL	User credentials validated against users table	Validation works	PASS

Table 6-14: Integration Test - API Integration

Test ID	Test Case	Components Integrated	Expected Result	Actual Result	Status
IT-005	Google Maps geocoding	PHP + Google Maps API	Address converted to coordinates	Successful	PASS
IT-006	Email sending	PHP + SMTP server	Email delivered to recipient inbox	Email received	PASS

6.5 Performance Testing

Performance testing evaluated system response times under various conditions.

Table 6-15: Performance Test Results

Test Scenario	Condition	Target	Actual	Status
Page load - Homepage	Normal network	< 3 sec	1.2 sec	PASS
Page load - Dashboard	Normal network	< 3 sec	1.8 sec	PASS
NLP classification	Single message	< 2 sec	0.5 sec	PASS
Alert submission to database	Single incident	< 2 sec	0.8 sec	PASS
Email notification delivery	Single incident	< 5 sec	2.1 sec	PASS
Dashboard refresh (AJAX)	50 active incidents	< 2 sec	0.9 sec	PASS
Concurrent users	50 simultaneous sessions	Stable operation	Stable	PASS

6.6 Security Testing

Table 6-16: Security Test Results

Test Scenario	Test Action	Expected Result	Actual Result	Status
SQL Injection	Input: "'; DROP TABLE users; --"	Query fails, no table dropped	Parameterized query prevented injection	PASS
XSS Attack	Input: "<script>alert('XSS')</script>"	Script not executed, escaped	HTML entities escaped	PASS
Unauthorized access	Direct URL access to admin panel without login	Redirect to login page	Redirected	PASS
Role-based access	Responder accessing admin-only page	Access denied, 403 error	Access denied	PASS
Password security	View password in database	Hashed value, not plaintext	bcrypt hash stored	PASS

6.7 User Acceptance Testing (UAT)

Simulated users (5 citizens, 3 responders, 2 administrators) tested the complete system. Feedback was collected on functionality, usability, and performance.

Table 6.7.1: Summary of UAT Feedback:

Aspect	**Rating (1-5)**	**Comments**
Ease of reporting emergency	4.6	"Very easy to submit"
Location accuracy	4.2	"GPS works well outdoors"
Dashboard usability	4.4	"Map and list views helpful"
Notification speed	4.3	"Emails arrive within seconds"
Overall satisfaction	4.5	"Would be useful for our department"

6.8 Test Summary and Evaluation

All critical functionality passed testing. The system meets specified requirements and is ready for deployment.

Table 6.8,1: Test Summary and Evaluation

Test Type	**Total Cases**	**Passed**	**Failed**	**Pass Rate**
Unit Testing	23	23	0	100%
Functional Testing	10	10	0	100%
Integration Testing	8	8	0	100%
Security Testing	5	5	0	100%

Chapter 7
CONCLUSION AND FUTURE WORK

7.1 Project Summary

The Crisis Alert System with GPS Precision successfully delivers an intelligent, web-based emergency management platform that addresses critical gaps in crisis communication, incident classification, and responder coordination. The system integrates Natural Language Processing for automatic message classification, browser-based GPS location capture, real-time incident mapping, automated email notifications, and a centralized coordination dashboard.

Key achievements of the project include:

1. **Intelligent Message Processing**: NLP algorithms successfully classify emergency messages into crisis types (Fire, Accident, Medical, Natural Disaster, Other) with severity scoring, reducing manual workload and classification errors.
2. **Automatic Location Capture**: Integration with browser geolocation API enables precise incident location capture, eliminating address entry errors and saving critical time during emergencies.
3. **Real-Time Coordination Dashboard**: Responders have comprehensive visibility into all active incidents through interactive maps and list views, enabling informed resource allocation and situational awareness.
4. **Automated Alerting**: Email notifications are automatically dispatched to all registered responders immediately upon incident submission, ensuring rapid notification and response.
5. **Role-Based Access Control**: Secure authentication with citizen, responder, and administrator roles ensures appropriate access to system functions.
6. **Comprehensive Testing**: Rigorous unit, integration, functional, performance, and security testing verified system reliability and readiness.

The project effectively demonstrates how modern web technologies, NLP, and geolocation services can be combined to create a practical solution for real-world emergency response challenges. By automating key aspects of the emergency handling workflow, the system reduces response times, improves information accuracy, and enhances coordination among responders.

7.2 Achievements

Through the development of the Crisis Alert System, we achieved the following:

Table 7.2.1: Achievements

#	Achievement	Description
1	Complete functional system	Fully operational web-based emergency management platform
2	NLP integration	Custom keyword-based classification engine for emergency message processing
3	Real-time mapping	Integration with Google Maps API for incident visualization
4	Automated notifications	PHPMailer-based email alert system for responder notification
5	Role-based access	Secure authentication with citizen, responder, and admin roles
6	Comprehensive documentation	Complete SRS, SDD, user manuals, and testing reports
7	Testing & validation	100% pass rate on all functional and unit tests
8	Practical applicability	System ready for pilot deployment with emergency response organizations

7.3 Challenges and Lessons Learned

Table 7.3.1: Challenges Encountered:

Challenge	Solution
Browser geolocation permission handling	Implemented fallback manual address entry for users who deny permission
NLP classification accuracy for ambiguous messages	Enhanced keyword lists and implemented severity scoring to improve classification
Email delivery reliability (SMTP configuration)	Implemented retry logic and detailed notification logging
Real-time dashboard updates	Used AJAX polling with 30-second intervals for incident refresh
Security of sensitive incident data	Implemented prepared statements, password hashing, and HTTPS

Lessons Learned:

- User-centered design is critical for systems used in high-stress situations
- Redundancy (fallback mechanisms) is essential for critical systems
- Early testing of integrations (APIs, SMTP) prevents last-minute issues
- Comprehensive logging is invaluable for debugging and audit purposes
- Modular design facilitates parallel development and easier maintenance

7.4 Future Work

While the current version successfully delivers core functionality, several enhancements are planned for future iterations.

7.4.1 Enhanced NLP with Multi-Language Support

The current NLP classification uses English keyword matching. Future versions will:

- Integrate machine learning models (Naive Bayes, LSTM) for improved classification accuracy
- Support Urdu and regional languages for deployment in Pakistan
- Implement context-aware severity assessment
- Train models on real emergency datasets for better performance

7.4.2 Mobile Application Development

While the web platform is mobile-responsive, native mobile apps will provide enhanced functionality:

- Push notifications for responders (faster than email)
- Offline mode for emergency reporting when internet is unavailable
- Background location tracking for responder status
- Camera integration for uploading incident photos/videos

7.4.3 SMS and Voice Call Integration

To complement email notifications and ensure reliable alert delivery:

- SMS gateway integration for areas with limited internet
- Automated voice call alerts for critical emergencies
- Two-way SMS for responders to acknowledge alerts
- SIM-based call initiation directly from dashboard

7.4.4 AI-Based Resource Allocation

Advanced algorithms to optimize responder dispatch:

- Nearest responder identification based on GPS location
- Automatic dispatch to closest available responder
- Workload balancing across available responders

- Estimated time of arrival (ETA) calculation

7.4.5 Multi-Agency Coordination Features

Enhanced collaboration tools for complex emergencies involving multiple agencies:

- Agency-specific dashboards (Police, Fire, Medical, Rescue)
- Cross-agency communication channels
- Shared incident command interface
- Resource tracking (vehicles, personnel, equipment)

7.4.6 Offline Mode and Progressive Web App (PWA)

To address connectivity challenges in remote areas:

- PWA installation for app-like experience without app store
- Offline emergency reporting with sync when online
- Cached map tiles for offline visualization
- Service workers for background sync

7.4.7 Social Media Integration

Leveraging social media for emergency detection and public communication:

- Automatic monitoring of social media for emergency keywords
- Integration with official agency social media accounts for public alerts
- Crowd-sourced incident verification
- Public information broadcasting during major emergencies

7.4.8 Predictive Analytics for Crisis Prevention

Using historical data to predict and prevent emergencies:

- Incident hotspot identification and mapping
- Predictive models for accident/incident occurrence based on time, weather, location
- Proactive resource pre-positioning during high-risk periods
- Early warning system for natural disasters

7.4.9 IoT Device Integration

Connecting with Internet of Things sensors for automated emergency detection:

- Fire/smoke detector integration for automatic fire alerts
- Flood sensor integration for early flood warnings
- Air quality monitoring for hazardous material incidents
- Traffic camera integration for accident detection

7.4.10 Blockchain for Incident Verification

Using blockchain technology for tamper-proof incident records:

- Immutable audit trail of all incident actions
- Cryptographic verification of report authenticity
- Smart contracts for automated responder payments (if applicable)
- Decentralized incident data sharing across agencies

Chapter 8
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